



ASEAN
SUSTAINABLE
URBANISATION
FORUM
KUALA LUMPUR



ASEAN
GOVERNORS
AND MAYORS
FORUM

MGMAC
2025
Meeting of
Governors and
Mayors of
ASEAN Capitals



ASEAN Future Cities and Regions:
Inclusivity and Sustainability
10-15 August 2025
Kuala Lumpur Convention Centre (KLCC)
KUALA LUMPUR, MALAYSIA

Accelerating the Implementation
of the ASEAN Sustainable Urbanisation Strategy – Phase II

ASEAN SUSTAINABLE URBANISATION FORUM 2025

EVENT REPORT



Kuala Lumpur
12,13, and 14 August 2025





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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

In response to the critical challenges posed by rapid urban transformations in ASEAN, the ASEAN Sustainable Urbanisation Forum (ASUF) 2025 was convened alongside the ASEAN Governors & Mayors Forum (AGMF) and the Meeting of Governors & Mayors of ASEAN Capitals (MGMAC), between the 12th and the 14th of August 2025 in Kuala Lumpur, guided by the shared theme "ASEAN Future Cities and Regions: Inclusivity and Sustainability".

ASUF 2025 was convened as a high-level regional platform to accelerate knowledge exchange, strengthen partnerships, and support the implementation of sustainable urbanisation practices across ASEAN. Building on the momentum of previous forums, ASUF 2025 provided a unique opportunity to align city-level action with the ASEAN Sustainable Urbanisation Strategy (ASUS), the Master Plan on ASEAN Connectivity (MPAC) 2025, and global frameworks such as the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and the New Urban Agenda (NUA).

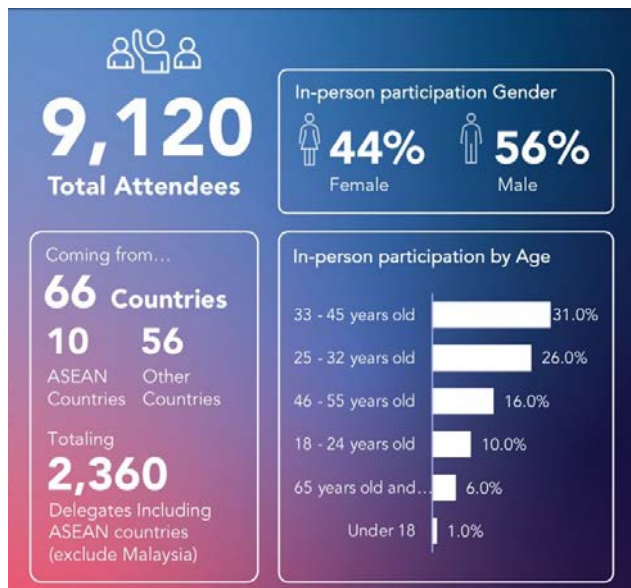
The Forum brought together a diverse group of stakeholders, including government officials, city leaders, development agencies, private sector actors, academia, and civil society organisations. Through plenary discussions, thematic dialogues, and a training session, ASUF 2025 facilitated the exchange of lessons learned and innovative practices. The event highlighted how regional and local actors can work collaboratively to address pressing urban challenges while ensuring inclusivity, resilience, and long-term sustainability.

Central to the discussions were the **ASUS enablers and thematic areas**, which remain highly relevant to the needs of ASEAN cities. Discussions around the enablers addressed dynamic urban governance, integrated master planning and development, partnership and funding, digital infrastructure and application, in relation to thematic areas such as water, waste and sanitation, sustainable mobility, urban resilience and personal safety and security. The Forum underscored the importance of embedding these priorities into city-level planning processes.

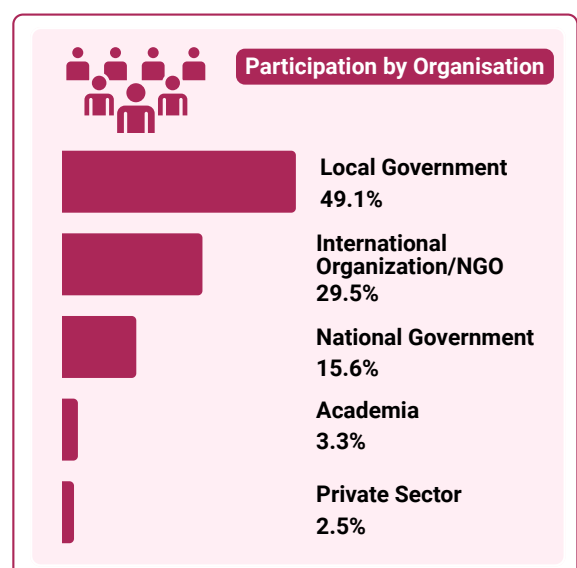
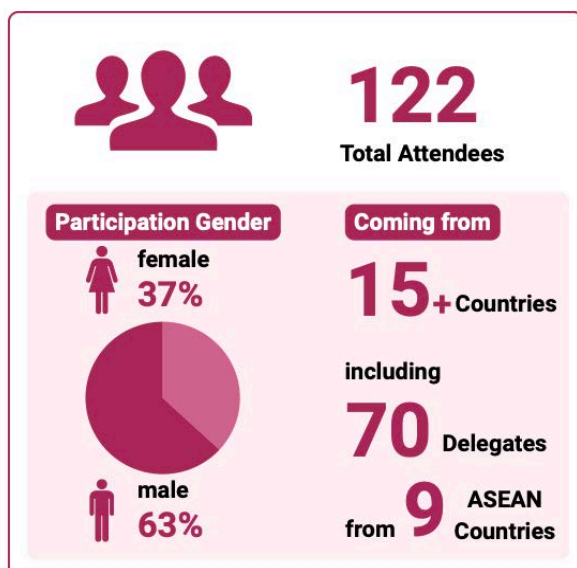
Key themes that emerged throughout ASUF 2025 included:

- **Urban resilience and climate action:** Cities across ASEAN face increasing risks from climate change, natural disasters, and environmental degradation. Discussions emphasised the urgency of integrating resilience into planning, investing in protective infrastructure, and strengthening early warning and preparedness systems.
- **Access to essential services:** Water, waste, and sanitation remain critical challenges in many urban areas, particularly in informal settlements. Participants called for stronger investments, inclusive governance, and community participation to ensure clean, liveable, and healthy urban environments.
- **Inclusive and equitable development:** Social inclusion, gender equality, and youth empowerment were highlighted as cross-cutting themes. The Forum stressed the need to address the needs of women and vulnerable groups in design urban policies and programmes, by involving them since the design and programmes implementation. This is to ensure that no one is left behind.
- **Mobility and connectivity:** Sustainable mobility systems were identified as key enablers for productivity and quality of life. Cities and experts shared innovative approaches to improving public transport, reducing congestion, promoting active and low-carbon transport solutions and improving public transport accessibility, safety and security, especially for women.
- **Digitalisation and innovation:** The Forum recognised the transformative potential of digital tools in supporting evidence-based planning, service delivery, and regional knowledge exchange. However, discussions also noted the need to balance innovation with safeguards for privacy, equity, and accessibility.

Together, ASUF 2025, AGMF and MGMAC, gathered **9,120 attendees from 66 countries**, with **2,360 delegates** representing ASEAN nations. Participation was fairly balanced by gender (44% female, 56% male) and spanned across age groups, with the largest share aged 33–45 years. In total, **2,324 attendees represented 201 local governments**, primarily from ASEAN countries. Representatives from international organisations, NGOs, academia and research institutions, the private sector and civil society accounted for 39% of total participants. The event featured **391 speakers** across main sessions, stakeholder assemblies, and city stages, as well as **74 exhibitors** including governments, NGOs, universities, and enterprises.



Focusing on ASUF 2025, the event was marked by broad and diverse participation of representatives directly sponsored and engaged by the ASUS Project Phase II, with 122 delegates from over 15 countries, including nine ASEAN Member States. Women comprised 37% of all participants. The event also succeeded in convening a wide spectrum of stakeholders: nearly half of participants represented local governments (49.1%), followed by international organisations and NGOs (29.5%), national governments (15.6%), academia (3.3%), and the private sector (2.5%).



A total of 45 speakers contributed to the programme across high-level dialogues, special sessions, and training activities. Representation was balanced across sectors, with voices from local and national governments, international organisations, academia, and the private sector ensuring rich exchanges of knowledge and perspectives. These figures reflect the Forum’s role as an inclusive platform, fostering collaboration across sectors, disciplines, and geographies to advance sustainable urbanisation.



Another central outcome of the Forum was the reaffirmation of the need to strengthen **regional cooperation and knowledge-sharing**. Participants emphasised that ASEAN cities face common challenges but also hold unique experiences that, when shared, can accelerate the replication and scaling of successful models.

In sum, ASUF 2025 reaffirmed its role as an important platform for regional cooperation and knowledge exchange on sustainable urbanisation. It successfully bridged the gap between policy and practice, national and local priorities, and development and financing needs. By convening leaders and practitioners from across ASEAN and beyond, the Forum catalysed renewed commitments to scale up sustainable urbanisation efforts, deepen collaboration, and advance a shared vision of inclusive, resilient, and future-ready cities for the ASEAN region.

INTRODUCTION

BACKGROUND

The Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) is one of the most rapidly urbanizing regions in the world. As of 2025, over half of the population in ASEAN resides in urban areas, a figure poised to rise to 55.6% by 2030. Such growth is not only centred in major metropolitan areas like Jakarta, Manila, Bangkok, and Kuala Lumpur, but also increasingly in emerging secondary and smaller cities, where the majority of growth is now taking place.

However, this rapid urban development also brings forth numerous challenges, including environment degradation, rising energy demands, urban sprawl, and rural-urban imbalances. Additional concerns entail ineffective waste management, limited access to affordable housing, escalating congestion, inadequate infrastructure, and insufficient provision of social services. These challenges have exacerbated inequalities and trapped several urban residents living in multidimensional poverty.

Addressing these challenges necessitates immediate, effective, and innovative solutions that prioritize sustainability and inclusivity. Sustainable urban planning must be at the forefront of development initiatives to ensure that economic growth does not come at the expense of the environment or the well-being, especially for the marginalized communities. This necessitates a shift towards creating urban spaces that are not only environmentally friendly but also accessible and equitable for all residents.

The ASEAN Sustainable Urbanisation Forum (ASUF) serves as a critical platform to address these issues. Convened to support the implementation of regional frameworks such as the ASEAN Sustainable Urbanisation Strategy (ASUS) and the ASEAN Smart Cities Network (ASCN), ASUF brings together a diverse range of stakeholders – including representatives from government, academia, international organizations and NGOs, urban planners, industry experts, and community members. The forum was designed to facilitate knowledge sharing, promote innovative solutions, and strengthen regional cooperation to build more resilient, inclusive, and environmentally conscious urban environments.

The ASEAN Sustainable Urbanisation Forum (ASUF) 2025 stands as a landmark event, being the first urban forum hosted by an ASEAN Chair. This forum underscored the pressing need for a collaborative and common approach to tackle the complex challenges posed by urbanization in the region. Among its key focus was to strengthen local policy frameworks, promote innovative mechanisms and harness new technology for the development of inclusive and sustainable cities, and to enhance regional cooperation.

KEY OBJECTIVES

- **Connect:** ASUF 2025 provided a platform for ASEAN cities and local government leaders, policymakers, and experts to share innovative strategies for sustainable urban development.
- **Share:** To forum fostered regional and international collaboration among city and local government leaders, organisations, and institutions in addressing urban challenges.
- **Inclusivity:** It encouraged inclusive urban policies that prioritise equal access to healthcare, housing, and economic opportunities.
- **Transformation:** ASUF 2025 enhanced the role of technology and digital innovation in strengthening city governance and public services.

STRUCTURE & DETAILS

The ASEAN Sustainable Urbanisation Forum (ASUF) 2025 was strategically structured into diverse sections including High-level Dialogues and Special Sessions, to foster comprehensive dialogue, knowledge exchange and collaborative problem-solving among a diverse group of stakeholders.

DAY 1:

High-Level Dialogue 1 - ASEAN Community Vision 2045 and ASEAN Connectivity Strategic Plan 2035

This High-level Dialogue brought together key stakeholders and partners to present and discuss the ASEAN Community Vision 2045 and the ASEAN Connectivity Strategic Plan 2026-2035, reflecting on the transition between the existing and the renewed priorities of the ASEAN connectivity agenda.

Special Session 5 - Integrated Planning for Resilient Urban Futures

The special session explored how cities and government agencies can engage and collaborate on planning processes across a range of scales, from territorial and regional planning to infrastructure development and neighbourhood-level urban design, to improve sustainability and pilot new solutions.

DAY 2:

High-Level Dialogue 3 - Implementation of the ASEAN Sustainable Urbanization Strategy (ASUS) and The ASEAN Smart Cities Network (ASCN)

This High-level Dialogue convened key stakeholders and partners to present and discuss initiatives and progress in implementing regional and national agendas, starting from ASUS, ASCN and the ASEAN Smart Cities Framework, and the local progress in achieving the global development agendas.

Special Session 8 - Safer and Inclusive Cities

The special session explored a dual strategy: improving the physical design and governance of urban spaces while simultaneously integrating community-driven processes and responsible use of digital innovation to ensure safety and inclusivity for all.

Special Session 9 - Digital Transformation and Innovative Cities

The special session explored how cities and government agencies can leverage the opportunities of digitalisation adapted to their specific context to enhance public service delivery and public sector engagement, while ensuring that human rights and privacy are respected.

Special Session 10 - Reimagining Urban Governance through Integration and Inclusion

The special session focused on how cities and government agencies can work innovatively across different levels; with other urban stakeholders and the communities they serve.

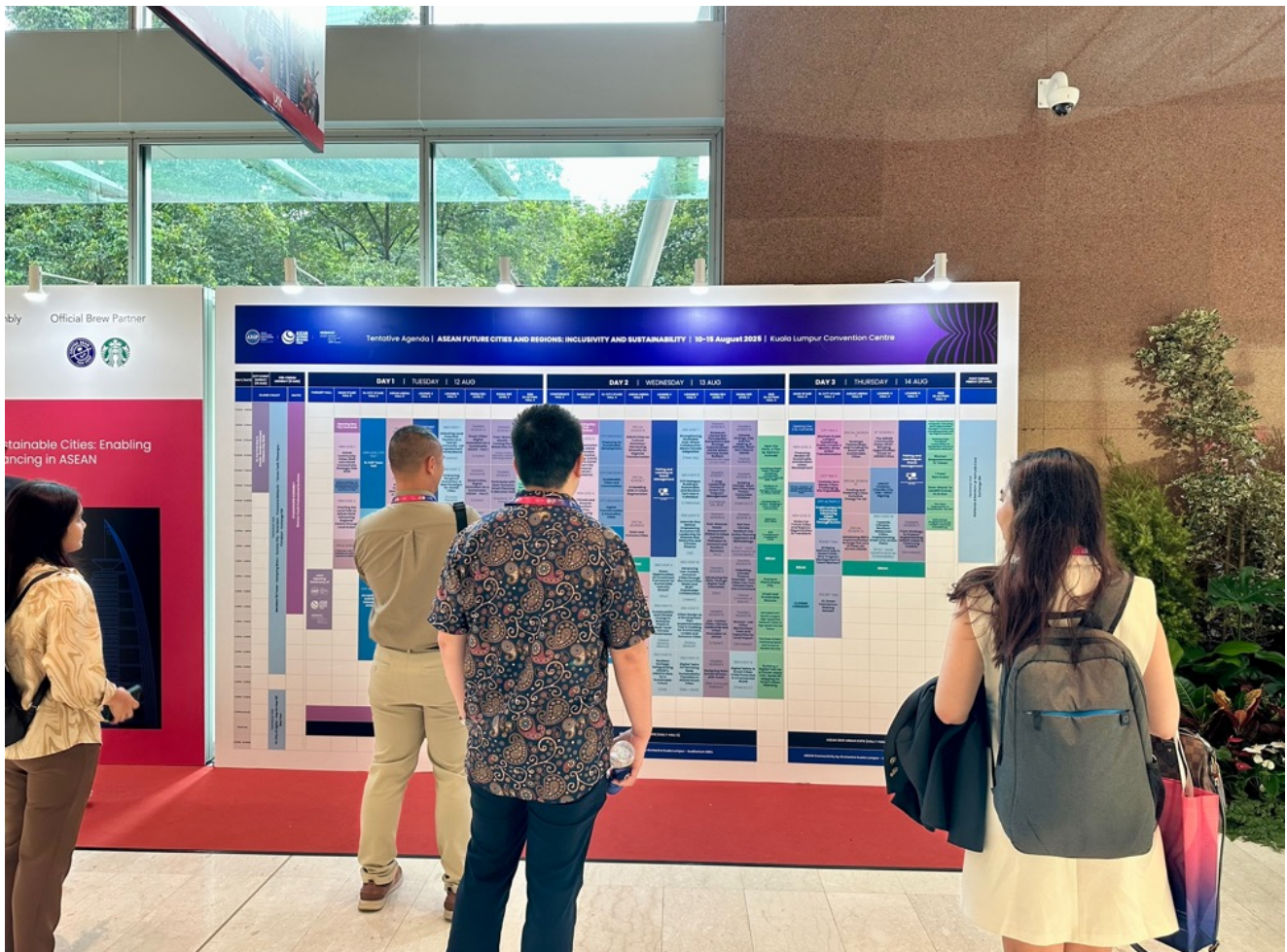
DAY 3:

Special Session 11 - Strategic Partnerships and Funding for Smart and Sustainable Cities

The special session focused on how cities and government agencies can optimise funding, increased local government revenue and community-based savings; especially, by leveraging partnerships with UN agencies, development partners and the private sector.

Training Session – From Strategy to Impact: Implementing ASEAN Urban and Financing Toolkits

The training session focused on how cities can prioritise their needs in line with ASEAN 2045 Vision and Strategic Plans. Participants explored the ASEAN Sustainable Urbanisation Strategy (ASUS) and Smart City Financing Toolkit, designed to help cities develop sound, investment-ready proposals that integrate financial strategies with sustainability and inclusivity priorities.



HIGH-LEVEL DIALOGUE ON THE ASEAN COMMUNITY VISION 2045 AND ASEAN CONNECTIVITY STRATEGIC PLAN 2035

SPEAKERS

Name	Position and Organisation	Role
Mr. Bingxun Seng	Partner, Ernst & Young	Moderator
Mr. Lim Chze Cheen	Director, Connectivity Division, ASEAN Secretariat	Speaker
Ms. Lara Franzen	Development Counsellor of the Australian Mission to ASEAN	Speaker
Ms. Kazuko Ishigaki	Regional Director, UN-Habitat ROAP	Speaker
Mr. Mohd Hazli bin Ahmad	Deputy Secretary General (Sustainability and Strategic Planning), Ministry of Housing and Local Government, Malaysia	Speaker
Ms. Duangruetai Surasakjinda	Deputy Director, Indonesia-Malaysia-Thailand Growth-Triangle Subregional Cooperation (CIMT)	Speaker

SESSION OBJECTIVES

- Present and discuss the recently adopted ASEAN Community Vision 2045 and the ASEAN Connectivity Strategic Plan 2026-2035;
- Provide participants with an understanding of what ASEAN Sustainable Urbanisation Strategy and ASEAN Smart Cities Networks are and their essential role for the ASEAN Connectivity Strategic Plan 2026-2035;
- Share initiatives from key stakeholders and partners, in alignment with representatives from private sector and government officials and discuss progress in implementing regional agendas;
- Offer opportunities for attendees with a background in sustainable urban development and from different fields of interest to participate and explore new perspectives, knowledge, practices, and solutions.

SUMMARY OF PRESENTATIONS

KEYNOTE PRESENTATION

SPEAKER:

Mr. Lim Chze Cheen, Director, Connectivity Division, ASEAN Secretariat

SUMMARY

Mr. Lim Chze Cheen called for enhanced coordination, ownership, and capacity building to overcome implementation challenges in ASEAN Connectivity. He emphasized the inclusion of smart and sustainable urban development as a standalone strategic area and the need for agile, responsive workplans and stakeholder collaboration.



He presented the ASEAN Connectivity Strategic Plan (ACSP), highlighting it as a key document for progress. With a diverse combination of 6 strategic goals, 14 objectives and 49 strategic measures, it expands scope to include smart and sustainable urban development, broader people-to-people linkages, and a more agile, responsive workplan.

Lastly, he drew attention to the relevance of translating strategy into action. Giving a few examples, this could be achieved by fostering multi-stakeholder collaboration, applying lessons from past successes, and actively mobilizing ideas and resources for concrete, impactful projects. A direct invitation was extended to all stakeholders to contribute ideas and proposals, which are essential for translating the strategic measures of the ACSP into tangible activities and projects.



SPEAKER:

Ms. Lara Franzen, Development Counsellor, Mission of Australia to ASEAN

SUMMARY

Ms. Lara Franzen reaffirmed Australia's long-standing partnership with ASEAN and highlighted continued investments supporting ASEAN Connectivity and smart sustainable development.

She stressed the importance of implementing the ASEAN Connectivity Strategic Plan (ACSP) 2025 to advance people-to-people links. This ensures communities gain access to markets and services while addressing emerging challenges like aging populations.



She also highlighted the need for innovative financing tools to fund urban infrastructure. Tools like the ASEAN Smart City Financing Toolkit are crucial for encouraging greater private sector participation and helping local governments bridge funding gaps.

SPEAKER:

Ms. Kazuko Ishigaki, Regional Director, Regional Office for Asia and the Pacific, UN-Habitat

SUMMARY

Ms. Kazuko Ishigaki emphasized ASEAN initiatives in smart and sustainable urban development as being well-aligned with the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). She mentioned that the ASEAN Sustainable Urbanisation Strategy (ASUS) prioritizes key areas such as affordable housing, strengthening urban-rural linkages, rural empowerment, and environmental sustainability.



She called for strengthening governance frameworks and addressing the digital divide, and encouraged the adoption of data-driven approaches, such as SDG localization and urban data monitoring, to guide policy and measure progress.

SPEAKER:

Ms. Duangruetai Surasakjinda, Deputy Director, Centre for Indonesia-Malaysia-Thailand Growth-Triangle Subregional Cooperation (CIMT)

SUMMARY

Ms. Duangruetai Surasakjinda shared CIMT role in accelerating subregional cooperation by localizing ASEAN strategies, particularly in sustainable urban development and infrastructure, underlining the alignment of subregional agendas with ACSP's six strategic areas.

She mentioned that high importance should be given to project mobilization and implementation, with a strong emphasis on leveraging public-private partnerships



(PPPs) to fund and execute infrastructure projects. Lastly, she highlighted the importance of raising awareness and building capacity at the local level to ensure that local governments and communities can effectively participate in and benefit from subregional initiatives.

CONCLUDING REMARKS**SPEAKER:**

Mr. Mohd Hazli bin Ahmad, Deputy Secretary General (Sustainability and Strategic Planning), Ministry of Housing and Local Government

SUMMARY

Mr. Mohd Hazli bin Ahmad emphasized that while urban growth drives economic dynamism, it also creates urgent challenges, including environmental degradation, infrastructure gaps, and inequality. It is essential to develop solutions that ensure cities remain liveable and that the benefits of growth are shared by all, directly supporting the ambitious ASEAN Community Vision 2045.

He underscored the importance of translating high-level goals, such as the Kuala Lumpur Declaration on ASEAN 2045, into concrete local action. The upcoming



ASEAN Connectivity Strategic Plan 2026–2035, was identified as a vital instrument for this purpose, moving beyond planning to tangible implementation. Building a resilient and sustainable urban future for ASEAN depends on a unified commitment to cooperation, innovation, and inclusivity. A call to action was made for all stakeholders to leave with a renewed dedication to working together, recognizing that the choices made today will shape the region for decades.

“Connectivity goes beyond transport—it’s about linking policies and people.”

Mr. Mohd Hazli bin Ahmad

QUESTIONS AND DISCUSSION POINTS

1. In ensuring the successful implementation of the ASEAN Connectivity Strategic Plan, ASEAN partners’ involvement is crucial.

What can ASEAN partners contribute to the successful implementation of ASEAN Connectivity Strategic Plan?

How can ASEAN and partners engage more effectively?



SPEAKER:

Ms. Lara Franzen, Development Counsellor, Mission of Australia to ASEAN

Ms. Lara Franzen explained that ASEAN partners can contribute most effectively by helping to mobilize significant private investment through innovative financing mechanisms. She emphasized that support should extend beyond physical infrastructure to also focus on building strong institutional capacity for long-term asset management.

She stressed that to be successful, these efforts must be grounded in a clear understanding of national and local needs, ensuring that support is well-aligned and addresses technical capacity gaps where they exist.

2. Noting the greater emphasis on Smart and Sustainable Urban Development in the ASEAN Connectivity Strategic Plan, how can this be synergised with the global efforts on smart cities and sustainable urbanisation?



SPEAKER:

Ms. Kazuko Ishigaki, Regional Director, Regional Office for Asia and the Pacific, UN-Habitat

Ms. Ishigaki highlighted the strong synergy between ASEAN’s focus on sustainable urban development and the SDGs. She noted that regional priorities such as housing, strengthening urban-rural linkages, and promoting inclusivity align directly with UN-Habitat’s global goals.

To further enhance this synergy, she encouraged the adoption of data-driven approaches, such as SDG localization and improved urban data monitoring, to support informed policymaking and effectively track progress

“Smart and sustainable urban development must be at the heart of regional cooperation.”

Ms. Kazuko Ishigaki

3. How can subregional cooperation platforms like IMT-GT contribute to the implementation of the ASEAN Connectivity Strategic Plan 2026–2035, particularly in advancing the smart and sustainable urban development?

SPEAKER:

Ms. Duangruetai Surasakjinda, Deputy Director, CIMT

Ms. Duangruetai Surasakjinda explained that subregional platforms like the CIMT are crucial for translating high-level ASEAN strategies into tangible action. Their primary role is to implement concrete sustainable urban development projects at the local level.

She mentioned that success in this area depends on two key supporting functions: building the capacity of local governments to manage these initiatives and raising awareness to ensure that local projects remain aligned with broader ASEAN-wide priorities.



4. ASEAN Secretariat supports the ASEAN Connectivity Coordinating Committee and ASEAN Smart Cities Network in coordinating and facilitating various ASEAN Connectivity initiatives. What are the challenges that the ASEAN Secretariat has faced in undertaking this role? How can we address these challenges?

SPEAKER:

Mr. Lim Chze Cheen, Director, Connectivity Division, ASEAN Secretariat

Mr. Lim Chze Cheen outlined three key dimensions of success for the ASEAN Secretariat. The first is ensuring effective coordination and alignment across a complex and expanding network of ASEAN sectoral bodies and external partners. The second is the critical hurdle of mobilizing finance, which involves moving projects beyond the proposal stage to secure actual funding. Finally, he stressed the need to establish robust monitoring and evaluation mechanisms to effectively track progress, learn from implementation, and measure the real-world impact of connectivity initiatives.



WAY FORWARD

- 1. Enhance Multi-Stakeholder Collaboration:** Success hinges on strong alignment across ASEAN bodies, various levels of government, academia, NGOs, community groups, the private sector, and development partners — therefore, strengthen multi-stakeholder platforms and coordination mechanisms to drive joint delivery.
- 2. Accelerate Innovative Financing:** To mobilize essential resources, strategic plans must be translated into bankable pilot projects with clear financing pathways that actively encourage private sector engagement and innovative funding models.
- 3. Promote Integrated Policies:** Sustainable urban development requires holistic and integrated policies that concurrently address interconnected social, economic, and environmental dimensions. Convert strategies into cross-sector programs and pilots that operationalize this integration.
- 4. Strengthen Capacity and Data-Driven Monitoring:** To ensure effective implementation and informed decision-making, it is critical to bolster capacity-building initiatives at local and subregional levels and promote robust data collection mechanisms aligned with the SDGs.



HIGH-LEVEL DIALOGUE ON THE IMPLEMENTATION OF THE ASEAN SUSTAINABLE URBANIZATION STRATEGY (ASUS) AND THE ASEAN SMART CITIES NETWORK (ASCN)

SPEAKERS

Name	Position and Organisation	Role
Mr. Abhineet Kaul	Director, Access Partnership	Moderator
Dr. Supakorn Siddhichai	Executive Vice-President, Digital Economy Promotion Agency, Thailand	Speaker
Ms. Lilian M. De Leon	Assistant Secretary for international relations, Department of the Interior and Local Government, Philippines	Speaker
Ms. Low Yen Ling	Senior Minister of State, Ministry of Trade and Industry and Youth in Singapore	Speaker
Dato Rudazaimeir Malek	Deputy Director, Community Services Department of Malaysia	Speaker
Datuk Wira M Noor Azman bin Taib	Secretary General, Ministry of Housing and Local Government, Malaysia	Speaker

SESSION OBJECTIVES

- Present and discuss initiatives and progress in implementing regional and national agendas, including the ASEAN Sustainable Urbanisation Strategy (ASUS) and the ASEAN Smart Cities Network (ASCN) initiative;
- Promote the implementation of ASUS, the growing network of ASCN and access to the ASEAN Smart Cities Financing Toolkit;
- Discuss a way forward in implementing ASUS and ASCN initiatives within the framework of the ASEAN Connectivity Strategic Plan.

SUMMARY OF PRESENTATIONS

KEYNOTE PRESENTATION

SPEAKER:

Dr. Supakorn Siddichai, Executive Vice-President, Digital Economy Promotion Agency, Thailand

SUMMARY

Dr. Supakorn Siddichai emphasised the pace of urbanisation across ASEAN, where more than half the population now lives in cities, with growth increasingly concentrated in intermediate rather than capital cities. He called for joint action to promote sustainable and smart urban development, outlining two flagship initiatives: the ASEAN Sustainable Urbanisation Strategy (ASUS) and the ASEAN Smart Cities Network (ASCN). The ASUS provides cities with a structured framework and toolkits to prioritise needs and design practical solutions, while the ASCN offers a platform for member cities to share experiences, create action plans, and mobilise partnerships.



He ended his presentation mentioning the Master Plan on ASEAN Connectivity (MPAC) 2025 and its successor, the ASEAN Connectivity Strategic Plan (ACSP) 2026–2035, initiatives that support the ASEAN Community Vision 2045, reaffirming ASEAN's commitment to advancing smart, inclusive, and sustainable cities that are resilient, innovative, and people-centred.

“People are not looking for new technology, they are looking for good solutions to help them relieve of these challenges that we are all facing.”

Dr. Supakorn Siddichai

SPEAKER:

Ms. Low Yen Ling, Senior Minister of State, Ministry of Trade and Industry and Youth in Singapore

SUMMARY

Ms. Low Yen Ling detailed Singapore's smart city strategy, which began with the establishment of the ASEAN Smart Cities Network (ASCN) in 2018. She explained how the land-scarce city-state leverages digital technology, IoT (Internet of Things) sensors, and AI to gather real-time data across infrastructure, transportation, and environmental systems for improving public services. Key initiatives include senior-focused technologies like fall-detection sensors in public housing and the disbursement of S\$2 billion in digital CDC vouchers to help households manage inflation, reflecting a "phygital" approach that blends digital efficiency with in-person support.



SPEAKER:

Ms. Lilian M. De Leon, Assistant Secretary for international relations, Department of the Interior and Local Government, Philippines

SUMMARY

Ms. Lilian M. De Leon outlined the Philippines' national framework for smart governance, the "DRIVE BAYAN" program. Another key initiative was the establishment of the Philippine Smart Local Governance Network, which serves as a platform for collaboration between local and national agencies, fosters capacity-building, and promotes data-driven policymaking.

Lastly, she noted that while a recent survey showed significant interest in smart city development among 115 cities, securing adequate funding remains a primary challenge for local governments.

**SPEAKER:**

Dato Rudazaimeir Malek, Deputy Director Community Services Department, Malaysia

SUMMARY

Dato Rudazaimeir Malek showcased Malaysia's project-driven approach to smart city implementation, using Kuching's initiatives under the Sarawak Digital Economy Strategy 2030. He highlighted tangible projects such as a centralized Integrated Operations Centre for state-wide surveillance, a hydrogen-powered public bus network, and smart streetlamp systems.



Finally, he also mentioned other advanced national projects, including the development of a Digital Twin for the city of Putrajaya, illustrating a focus on deploying practical and innovative solutions across the country.

CONCLUDING REMARKS**SPEAKER:**

Datuk Wira M Noor Azman bin Taib, Secretary General, Ministry of Housing and Local Government, Malaysia

SUMMARY

Datuk Wira M Noor Azman bin Taib emphasized that smart city development must be people-focused to enhance livability, driven by city-to-city cooperation to share solutions, and strategically aligned with global targets such as the Sustainable Development Goals. He underlined that building better cities is a shared, collaborative journey. As the 2025 ASEAN Chair, Malaysia reaffirmed its commitment to this vision, highlighting the central role of its Ministry of Housing and Local Government (KPKT) in driving progress.



“Smart and sustainable cities must be people-focused. Technology is important, but it should be used to make our cities safer, more livable, and fairer for everyone.”

Datuk Wira M Noor Azman Bin Taib

QUESTIONS AND DISCUSSION POINTS

1. Given Singapore's key role in the ASEAN Smart Cities Network, how can ASEAN Member States and cities further strengthen city-to-city collaboration within the region to accelerate digital innovation and ensure that smart city initiatives also contribute to inclusive urban development across the region?



SPEAKER:

Ms. Low Yen Ling, Senior Minister of State, Ministry of Trade and Industry & Ministry of Culture, Singapore

Ms. Low Yen Ling suggested leveraging the digital momentum gained during the COVID-19 pandemic. She advocated for a "phygital" (physical + digital) approach, where cities first use digital platforms to collaboratively define clear, common "problem statements." This allows for more focused discussions and effective engagement with private sector solution providers when they meet physically. She stressed that this method, combined with a "whole-of-government" mindset that breaks down silos, is key to advancing the network's goals.

2. Since the Philippines will be taking the role of chairmanship for the ASEAN Smart Cities Network next year, what are the practical steps that can be taken to advance the implementation of the ASEAN Sustainable Urbanisation Strategy?



SPEAKER:

Ms. Lilian M. De Leon, Assistant Secretary for international relations, Department of the Interior and Local Government, Philippines

Ms. Lilian M. De Leon outlined the Philippines' "whole-of-society" approach, which key steps include strengthening the institutional capacities of local governments, promoting data-driven governance through community-based monitoring systems and Voluntary Local Reviews (VLRs), and documenting best practices to facilitate city-to-city learning. These local actions are being systematically aligned with national frameworks, such as the climate adaptation plan and a forthcoming SDG-11 National Roadmap, to ensure coherence and impact.

3. As Mayor of the Commission of the City of Kuching North, which is part of the ASEAN Smart Cities Network, what initiatives has your city driven/is driving to ensure liveability and sustainable urbanisation?

SPEAKER:

Dato Rudazaimeir Malek, Deputy Director Community Services Department, Malaysia

Dato Rudazaimeir Malek explained Kuching's initiatives are guided by the state-level Sarawak Digital Economy Strategy 2030 and coordinated by the Sarawak Multimedia Authority. Concrete projects rolled out under the Kuching Smart City Master Plan include the Sarawak Integrated Operations Centre for centralized security and city management, a sustainable public bus network powered by hydrogen, and the development of a standardized, state-wide smart parking system to improve urban mobility.



4. What are some trends that will likely be predominant in the coming years that will either push or hinder sustainable urbanisation and more specifically, smart cities?

SPEAKER:

Dr. Supakorn Siddhichai, Executive Vice President of Digital Economy Promotion Agency, Thailand

Dr. Supakorn focused on the key opportunities for smart cities post-pandemic. He identified the chance to leapfrog to new technologies, particularly in renewable energy and smart grids. He also highlighted the growing importance of public-private partnerships to drive innovation, the potential for significant green job creation in sectors like sustainable construction, and the foundational need for data-driven approaches to effectively measure and improve outcomes.



WAY FORWARD

- 1. Adopt a People-First Approach:** Technology is a means to serve residents and improve safety, liveability, and inclusion. Embed social inclusion from the earliest design stages, with explicit provisions for vulnerable groups - such as the elderly, migrants and low income citizens - and measures to track equity of impact.
- 2. Foster Collaboration and Capacities:** Progress accelerates when cities learn from peers and partner across sectors. Strengthen ASEAN platforms to share knowledge, replicate proven solutions, and launch joint pilots among member cities.
- 3. Empowered Local Governments:** National strategies require capable local implementers. Provide targeted training and toolkits for local governments on project management, technology adoption, and financial planning to improve delivery.
- 4. Bankable Finance Pathways:** Funding gaps persist without early-stage finance design. Develop and mainstream innovative mechanisms—such as PPPs—and build financing plans into project concepts from the start to crowd in private capital.
- 5. Promote data-driven governance and community-based approaches:** Reliable, localized data underpins planning, monitoring, and evaluation. Use a community-based approach can ensure collaborative monitoring. Invest in robust data infrastructure and policies and institutionalize performance dashboards to guide evidence-based decisions.
- 6. Harmonize Standards and Guidelines:** Fragmented standards hinder scale. Work toward harmonized guidelines and interoperable technology systems across the region to streamline collaboration and accelerate cross-border implementation.



SPECIAL SESSION 5 - INTEGRATED PLANNING FOR RESILIENT URBAN FUTURES

SPEAKERS

Name	Position and Organisation	Role
Ms. Alissa Raj	Deputy Regional Director for East, Southeast Asia, and Oceania, C40 Cities	Moderator
Mr. Srinivasa Popuri	Chief, UN-Habitat Multi-Country Programme Office, Bangkok	Keynote Speaker
Ms. Aliyah Mustika Ilham	Vice Mayor, City of Makassar, Indonesia	Keynote Speaker
Mr. Yengher Vacha	Deputy Director, Luang Prabang City Cabinet Office, Lao PDR	Panellist
Mr. Akihito Muto	Chief Section, Smart Cities, Transit Oriented Development and Urban Development Department, Nippon Koei Co., Ltd	Panellist
Dr. Peeranan Towashiraporn	Director of Risk Analytics and Climate Services, Asian Disaster Preparedness Center (ADPC)	Panellist
Dr. Yogi Chellappan	Senior Manager & Interim Lead on Climate Resilience, Think City	Panellist

SESSION OBJECTIVES

- Highlight the importance of an integrated national, regional, and urban planning approach.
- Understand the importance of strengthening of urban and rural continuum.
- Promote inclusivity and meaningful citizens participation.
- Integrate the concepts of compact use, liveability and resilience in master planning and development strategies.

SUMMARY OF PRESENTATIONS

KEYNOTE PRESENTATION

SPEAKER:

Mr. Srinivasa Popuri, Chief, UN-Habitat Multi-Country Programme Office, Bangkok

SUMMARY

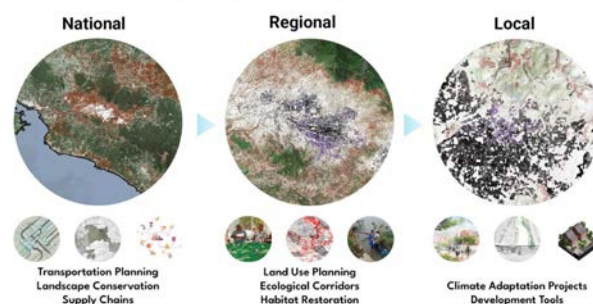
Mr. Srinivasa Popuri underlined the importance of integrated planning on building a resilient urban future. He identified fragmented, sectoral planning as a primary obstacle to addressing the interconnected crises facing ASEAN cities, such as flooding, heatwaves, and land subsidence. He argued for an urgent shift away from ad-hoc master planning toward a more strategic, integrated model that places housing, climate action, and social inclusion at its core.

The proposed solution is risk-informed, risk-sensitive planning. This requires a holistic approach that combines community engagement, innovative adaptation strategies, and enhanced data collection to guide climate initiatives. He also emphasized the need to transition to low-carbon energy sources, utilize technology like AI and GIS for rapid disaster modeling, and implement robust monitoring and reporting platforms.

Ultimately, he called for the creation of a unified ASEAN-wide Urban Resilience Framework. This framework would align the SDGs, the New Urban Agenda, and the Paris Agreement to provide clear, actionable guidance for member states in building a more resilient urban future.



Integrated Planning and Connectivity – A Path Forward



SPEAKER:

Ms. Aliyah Mustika Ilham, Vice Mayor of Makassar, Indonesia

SUMMARY

Ms. Aliyah Mustika Ilham provided a practical case study on the city of Makassar, detailing its challenges with rapid urbanization, climate impacts, infrastructure gaps, and social inequality. In response, Makassar has implemented the 'Sapta Mulia' program, a flagship initiative guided by the principle of leaving "no community and no place behind."

The program demonstrates an integrated approach to resilience. Technologically, it features the "Makassar Super App," which consolidates public services and citizen feedback. Socially, it addresses inequality through tangible support, including free installation of clean water systems, free school uniforms, and



assistance programs for vulnerable groups. This is complemented by community-focused infrastructure projects, such as a new stadium and a Creative Hub, designed to enhance collaboration and support local talent. Makassar's experience showcases a localized model that combines technology, social protection, and community engagement to build resilience from the ground up.

PANEL DISCUSSION HIGHLIGHTS

Mr. Yengher Vacha drew from his experience in Luang Prabang to explain that integration is hampered by mismatched priorities, differing budget cycles, and a top-down approach where national government projects often fail to address specific local needs. He called for a more holistic integration across sectoral plans, different levels of government, and between work plans and their corresponding budgets.

He also shared that Luang Prabang is now moving toward more proactive, participatory planning. The city is piloting an ICT-supported flood response system that directly involves the community, aiming to build a more collaborative and forward-looking approach to disaster management.



Mr. Akihito Muto illustrated the consequences with examples from industrial projects in Indonesia. He noted that a lack of coordination between multiple national and local master plans often results in misaligned infrastructure, such as road networks and utilities. This fragmentation forces developers to create their own isolated, inefficient plans for their specific blocks, undermining a cohesive regional development strategy.

He contrasted the "planning-oriented" approach in Japan, where projects are legally bound to follow master plans, with the more "activity-oriented" context in ASEAN. He observed that while the ASEAN approach allows for more creativity and market responsiveness, it requires a deliberate feedback loop where plans guide projects, but project outcomes and market demands are, in turn, used to update and refine the plans.

Akihito Muto provided a nuanced approach to balancing this flexibility with the need for certainty in infrastructure. He recommended that foundational civil works like land grading and core drainage systems should be designed for long-term certainty and resilience. In contrast, utilities like water and electricity should be developed in a phased and adaptive manner, allowing them to scale with demand. This avoids the high cost of overdesign while ensuring the core infrastructure is robust enough to handle extreme events.

He also affirmed that public participation significantly enriches projects, especially in tourism and cultural preservation, by incorporating local stories and community-sourced data. He noted that while digital platforms can aid engagement, care must be taken to avoid bias, and they should not replace the deep insights gained from primary data collection at the community level.

Dr. Yogi Chellappan shared an experience from a program in Penang, where misalignment between federal, state, and local governments created direct conflicts. Specifically, federal objectives for hard infrastructure flood management were at odds with state and local goals for promoting nature-based solutions and green infrastructure. She stressed that coordination must begin at the earliest stages of a project to align timelines, data, and governance structures. She presented a successful institutional model from Penang. She explained the use of legal steering committees that brought together federal, state, and local actors, along with partners like UN-Habitat. By establishing clear Terms of Reference (TORs) and dedicated technical teams from the outset, they were able to ensure alignment and effective collaboration throughout the project.

She also emphasized that vulnerable communities are not merely passive recipients but are the primary agents of change in building resilience. She finally described methods to ensure their active participation, including participatory risk mapping, providing community grants for greening projects like facades and rooftops, and co-curating project interventions.



“The lesson was very clear; coordination must start early with any intervention. Especially when you talk about climate risk, coordination must start early, and we need to align with shared goal.”

Dr. Yogi Chellappan

Dr. Peeranan Towashiraporn offered the pragmatic advice that external partners should aim to improve and work within existing government frameworks rather than imposing entirely new ones. He argued from experience that the most successful and sustainable outcomes are achieved by complementing and aligning with the plans and structures that local and national governments already have in place.



Peeranan Towashiraporn argued that in an era of climate change, planning frameworks must be fundamentally flexible. He stated that cities are constantly evolving and climate events are intensifying, meaning rigid, long-term plans are destined to become obsolete and ineffective.

He also pointed to the 2011 Bangkok floods as a stark example of lack of coordination. He argued that the prolonged and severe impact of the disaster was significantly worsened by inadequate joint decision-making and shared responsibility between the Bangkok city government and national authorities managing surrounding regions. This highlighted that disasters cross administrative boundaries and require robust mechanisms for inter-governmental collaboration.

Finally, he warned that technology like AI and GIS can widen the gap between experts and communities. To counter this, his projects used tools like 3D participatory maps, allowing community members to integrate their local knowledge with technical data. He also stressed that initiatives must be institutionalized and scaled up to ensure long-term impact, rather than ending as one-off pilot projects.

“Piloting means that you do the pilot, you stop and then everything dies. But we want to turn piloting into demonstrating, institutionalizing and scaling.”

Dr. Peeranan Towashiraporn

WAY FORWARD

1. Enhance Communication and Coordination in Governance: Urban challenges cut across sectors while clear communication prevents duplication and unlocks synergies. Institutionalize multi-sector planning processes and shared roadmaps across all government levels based on inter-agency coordination platforms.

2. Foster Adaptive and Participatory Planning: Community voice improves design and plans must flex as new evidence emerges. Center public participation with embedded feedback loops and engagement tools to stay responsive to community needs.

3. Strengthen Regional Climate & Disaster Resilience: Risks transcend administrative borders. Create cross-jurisdictional arrangements backed by national support and harmonizing city-level climate action.

4. From Pilots to Scale: Impact requires delivery beyond pilots. Pair national policy backing with city-level delivery management, clear milestones, financing plans, and M&E frameworks to move from Sinterventions to robust, cross-cutting planning and effective execution.



SPECIAL SESSION 5 - SAFER AND INCLUSIVE CITIES

SPEAKERS

Name	Position and Organisation	Role
Ms. Angela Mwai	Chief of the Human Rights and Social Inclusion, UN-Habitat Global Headquarters	Moderator
Dr. Kalpana Viswanath	Deputy Secretary of Development, Shah Alam, Malaysia	Keynote Speaker
TPr. Aniza Osman	Vice Mayor, City of Makassar, Indonesia	Keynote Speaker
H.E. Sor Vorin	Under Secretary of State, the Ministry of Interior in Cambodia	Panellist
Ms. Jitsadanooch Saengsri	Representative from Hayai City Municipality, Thailand	Panellist
Ms. Sri Husnaini Sofjan	Senior Program Administrator & Strategist, The Huairou Commission	Panellist
Mr. Gonggomtua Sitanggang	Southeast Asia Director, Institute for Transportation and Development Policy	Panellist

SESSION OBJECTIVES

- Share regional and local experiences in improving urban safety through inclusive planning and community engagement.
- Explore innovative tools, including smart technologies and citizen-led safety audits, to enhance both physical and digital security.
- Highlight good practices and institutional approaches that address the needs of vulnerable groups and enable co-produced safety outcomes.

SUMMARY OF PRESENTATIONS

KEYNOTE PRESENTATION

SPEAKER:

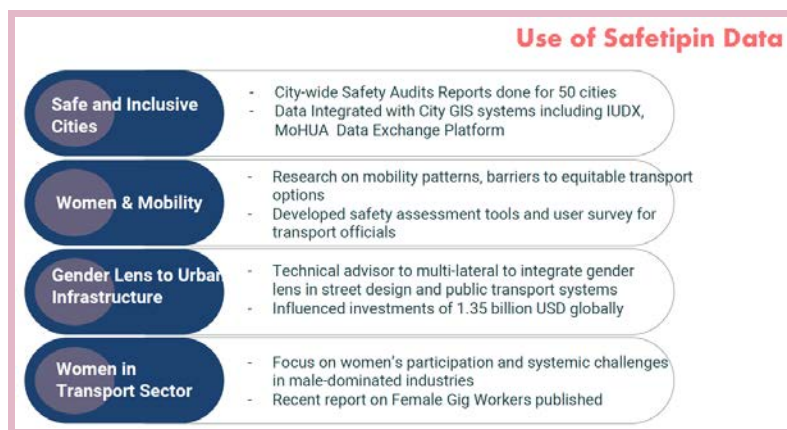
Dr. Kalpana Viswanath, Co-Founder & CEO, Safetipin

SUMMARY

Dr. Kalpana Viswanath highlighted the growing safety challenges posed by rapid urbanization in Southeast Asia. She explained that without inclusive planning, these expanding urban areas create safety gaps that disproportionately restrict women's mobility, education, and workforce participation, often compounded by the burden of unpaid care work.

To address this, Safetipin has developed a suite of digital tools, including the MySafetipin app, Safety Audits, and Site Mapping. These platforms empower women and communities to collect crucial safety data by assessing their surroundings, which provides actionable insights for improving urban design and infrastructure.

She showcased Safetipin's significant impact, noting the collection of over 600,000 data points across more than 75 cities, which has influenced over \$1.35 billion in investments for safer infrastructure. She cited successful case studies in Hanoi, Johor Bahru, and Sihanoukville where local safety audits led to tangible interventions.



Moving forward, she advocated for a holistic framework called “She RISES (Responsive, Inclusive, Safe, Equitable Systems)” to guide the creation of gender-responsive urban systems. She also emphasized that accurate, gender-disaggregated data is essential for designing effective safety solutions. Digital tools are critical for this data collection, but solutions must be adapted to local realities, and building the capacity of local governments to use this data is paramount.

“When you design for women, you also design for other excluded groups. Safety must be at the heart of city design.”

Dr. Kalpana Viswanath

SPEAKER:

TPr. Aniza Osman, Deputy Secretary of Development, Shah Alam, Malaysia

SUMMARY

TPr. Aniza Osman presented a localized solution for enhancing urban safety amidst rapid population growth, with the city projected to reach nearly 940,000 residents by 2035. As one of the cities in the ASEAN Smart Cities Network (ASCN), Shah Alam prioritized safety and security by establishing a central Big Data & Command Centre. This hub integrates diverse data streams, including CCTV surveillance, flood monitoring, transport tracking, and energy management, allowing for a holistic and data-driven approach to city governance and public safety.

The city's comprehensive Safe City Programme combines technological and community-focused initiatives. Key components include infrastructure upgrades like LED lighting and accessible public transport, advanced disaster preparedness using drones and AI-powered early warning systems, and crime prevention through expanded CCTV coverage and police-community partnerships.



Furthermore, urban beautification and the greening of back alleys were implemented to foster community pride and improve the perception of safety. The key insight from Shah Alam's experience is that data enables faster, more informed decisions. For continued success and scalability, the city is focused on strengthening partnerships with NGOs, academia, and the private sector, emphasizing that community involvement is non-negotiable for ensuring technology is both accepted and effective.

PANEL DISCUSSION HIGHLIGHTS

H.E. Sor Vorin outlined the government's policy-driven approach, highlighting the "Safe Village-Commune Policy" as a key legal framework. This policy provides local authorities with seven simple, manageable criteria to enhance citizen safety, designed to be effective even with limited resources. This is complemented by a national, step-by-step development planning process that guides cities in their urban planning, ensuring a consistent approach to development across the country.

He also emphasized that participatory governance is a core principle of Cambodia's strategy. He envisioned a crucial role for NGOs and organizations representing vulnerable groups, stressing the need to actively engage communities and ensure the voices of women, in particular, are heard in the decision-making process.

The call to action centered on fostering a multi-stakeholder model where partnerships are key to improving public services and safety. This involves empowering local authorities, strengthening regulatory frameworks, and aligning smart city initiatives with the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) by placing citizens at the center of all innovation.





Ms. Jitsadanooch Saengsri emphasized that gender-sensitive design and accessibility are foundational to the city's planning process. Hatyai institutionalizes this by embedding gender and accessibility criteria directly into its public space audits, ensuring new developments are gender-responsive and age-friendly. This policy is informed by direct community engagement through workshops and safety mapping exercises with women, youth, the elderly, and persons with disabilities. This entire approach is driven by a governance reform that created multi-sector Local Safety Task Forces—uniting municipal officials, police, health professionals, and civil society—to ensure that the needs of all residents are central to urban safety planning.

She explained that the city's most pressing challenges are flooding, road safety, and public security. To address these, Hatyai has implemented several community-centric initiatives. For flood resilience, the city established a Community-Based Flood Risk Management System, where residents collaborate on risk mapping and form "water watcher" volunteer networks. To enhance public security, a Collaborative CCTV Programme allows community members to decide on surveillance locations, boosting confidence while respecting privacy. Finally, road safety is being improved by redesigning high-risk intersections, upgrading pedestrian walkways, and launching Safe Routes to School initiatives.



Mr. Gonggomtua Sitanggang emphasized that successful collaborations involve three key stakeholders working in synergy: 1) Vulnerable Users & Civil Society: They act as co-designers of the system. CSOs play a crucial role by facilitating direct consultations with end-users (like women, children, and persons with disabilities) to ensure that transport planning responds to human needs, not vehicle needs. 2) City Authorities: As the on-the-ground implementers, local governments are essential partners that translate the co-designed concepts into practical infrastructure projects. 3) National Agencies: The national government provides the overarching structure by establishing clear policy guidelines that embed inclusive and accessible transport principles into a national framework.

He positioned CSOs as indispensable partners in the co-production of safer public spaces. Their primary function is to champion a shift from car-centric to people-centric planning by bringing the lived experiences of vulnerable groups directly into the design process. By leading participatory planning efforts, CSOs ensure that marginalized voices are not just heard but are actively involved in decision-making. This direct involvement guarantees that solutions—from the safety of a walkway to the accessibility of a bus stop—are truly reflective of the community's needs, creating a shared vision for inclusive mobility.



Ms. Sri Husnaini Sofjan explained that civil society organizations (CSOs) are essential partners in co-producing safer public spaces by championing a bottom-up, democratized process. Their primary role is to harness and channel local knowledge, enabling residents to identify safety hotspots and guide targeted interventions. CSOs facilitate participatory governance, ensuring that the community's lived experiences are not just heard but become the foundation for planning, which fosters a strong sense of local ownership over the safety of their environment. She argued that the most effective strategy is to institutionalize community participation within official government processes. This moves beyond informal consultations to create permanent, formal feedback loops that embed civil society input directly into municipal systems, policy, and implementation. When communities see their feedback consistently and transparently influencing decisions, it validates their contribution and builds lasting trust with local authorities, strengthening partnerships for sustainable safety outcomes.

WAY FORWARD

- 1. Strengthen Community Participation in Inclusive Urban Planning:** Make participation core to inclusive planning. Embed gender-sensitive design principles and universal accessibility standards in city planning, supported by capacity building programs that empower communities through direct consultation and participatory approaches.
- 2. Enhance Multi-Stakeholder Partnerships with Shared Understanding:** Achieving a common understanding and build multi-stakeholder coalitions among national ministries, city governments, civil society organisations, and the private sector. Encourage regional knowledge exchange platforms within ASEAN to replicate and adapt proven solutions.
- 3. Integrate Digital and Physical Safety Strategies:** Combine urban design measures—such as improved lighting, pedestrian-friendly infrastructure, and safe transport access—with digital safeguards addressing cybersecurity, privacy, and digital literacy. Support innovation in smart technologies that are community-centred and context-specific.



SPECIAL SESSION 9 - DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION AND INNOVATIVE CITIES

SPEAKERS

Name	Position and Organisation	Role
Ms. Sanjeevani Dilanthi Singh	Economic Affairs Officer, UN ESCAP	Moderator
Ms. Evi Syariffudin	Module Coordinator, Future Cities Lab, Singapore-ETH Centre	Keynote Speaker
Mr. Pradya Koamnee	Manager of Digital Economy Promotion Agency (DEPA) Upper-Northern Office, Chiang Mai, Thailand	Keynote Speaker
Mr. Lim Ymeng	Director One Window Service, Smart City Committee, Battambang Provincial Hall, Cambodia	Panellist
Dr. Tu Anh Trinh	Director of the Institute of Smart City and Management, University of Economics Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam	Panellist
Mr. Chang Ho Lee	Vice President, ESE, Korea	Panellist
Mr. Hairol Samad	General Manager - Smart Solution Division, Telekom Malaysia	Panellist

SESSION OBJECTIVES

- Discuss how digital transformation and innovative solutions can improve urban services, enhance inclusivity, and strengthen resilience in ASEAN cities.
- Present and exchange practical examples from city governments, private sector actors, and development partners on implementing smart city initiatives.
- Identify enabling conditions, including supportive policies, financing mechanisms, and capacity development, that allow cities to adopt and sustain digital innovations.
- Highlight challenges such as digital divide, data privacy, and interoperability, and explore strategies to address them.

“People first, technology second – solutions must come from the context, the community, and the real needs on the ground.”

Ms. Sanjeevani Dilanthi Singh

SUMMARY OF PRESENTATIONS

EXPERT DIVE-IN

SPEAKER:

Ms. Evi Syariffudin, Module Coordinator, Future Cities Lab, Singapore-ETH Centre

SUMMARY

Ms. Evi Syariffudin emphasized that for digital transformation to succeed, it must be human-centered, inclusive, and environmentally responsible. She argued that engagement processes must be designed to include diverse groups without overburdening them, citing a streamlined youth participation model in Singapore as an example. She showcased several real-world digital tools that embody this philosophy, including the Digital Twin Singapore for integrated urban planning, adaptive mobility algorithms that prioritize vulnerable users, and a platform for embedding the circular economy into city design.



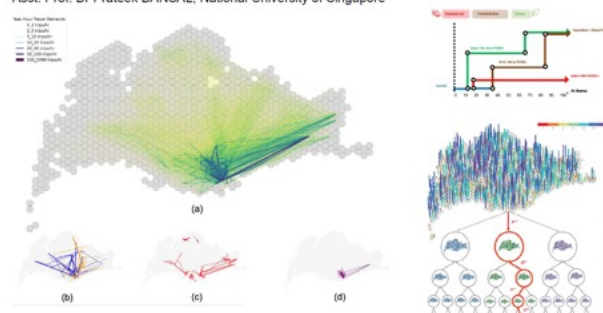
“We need both knowledge and imagination to create truly inclusive cities.”

Ms. Evi Syariffudin

Furthermore, she highlighted the importance of sustainability and climate resilience. This includes integrating nature-based materials, such as mycelium composites used for urban cooling, and harnessing data through projects like Cooling Singapore 2.0 to map and mitigate urban heat islands. A key call to action was to empower municipalities with data capacity, moving away from centralized control to localized platforms, like the one piloted in Bandung, Indonesia, that allow local staff to directly act on urban data.

Adaptive Mobility, Land Use and Infrastructure Resilient and Adaptive Transport Infrastructure Planning for City in Flux

Prof. Dr Bryan ADEY, ETH Zurich
Asst. Prof. Dr Prateek BANSAL, National University of Singapore



LOCALISED SOLUTION

SPEAKER:

Mr. Pradya Koamnee, Manager of Digital Economy Promotion Agency (DEPA) Upper-Northern Office, Chiang Mai, Thailand

SUMMARY

Mr. Pradya Koamnee explained how Chiang Mai is leveraging digital innovation to enhance its appeal as a safe and livable city by strategically integrating smart living with smart tourism. A core part of this strategy involves data-driven urban management, exemplified by a 3D model of Nimman City that uses Wi-Fi and AI behavior analysis to map tourist flows and manage crowd density. This data informs both urban design and the deployment of advanced safety technologies in key tourism zones.

To improve public safety, Chiang Mai has implemented AI Edge Terminal CCTV for functions like fire and weapon detection, helmet compliance, and vehicle violation monitoring. Beyond tourism and security, the city applies digital solutions to critical environmental challenges. This includes a Smart DustPole system to combat PM2.5 air pollution and an AI-powered water monitoring system for proactive flood management. Ultimately, these initiatives aim to foster sustainable and inclusive tourism growth, supporting local entrepreneurs and solidifying Chiang Mai's reputation as a national smart city model.



PANEL DISCUSSION HIGHLIGHTS



Mr. Lim Ymeng, focused on the practical application of digital tools to improve public service delivery. He described his city's dual-channel system, which offers residents the choice between in-person services and an online application portal that includes status tracking and a complaint mechanism. While acknowledging the challenge of managing multiple complex applications, he emphasized how even secondary cities can leverage digital governance to enhance efficiency, accessibility, and citizen satisfaction.

Dr. Tu Anh Trinh highlighted the critical need for inclusivity and local adaptation in smart city development. She called for ensuring that underserved communities have access to digital technology and that innovation is driven by community-informed data. Dr. Trinh championed a "glocal" approach—thinking globally while acting locally—where successful models are adjusted to fit Vietnam's unique realities, underscoring that community trust is best built by demonstrating the tangible benefits technology brings to residents.



Mr. Chang Ho Lee emphasized the power of strong regional partnerships in smart city development drawing on lessons from the K-City Network. He advocated for a model built on transparency, trust, and genuine local ownership, where local authorities are actively involved in decision-making. He pointed to shared investment models, like a disaster management project in the Philippines, and the importance of cross-border knowledge sharing to replicate successes and adapt strategies effectively across the region.



Mr. Hairol Samad focused on the foundational role of technology infrastructure, particularly the Internet of Things (IoT) and integrated data platforms. He argued that the key to modern urban governance is breaking down data silos between departments to enhance transparency and collaboration. By doing so, cities can better address challenges like rapid urbanization and climate change with data-driven strategies, ultimately empowering them with actionable insights for evidence-based decision-making and creating stronger public accountability.



WAY FORWARD

- 1. Adopt a People-First, Context-Driven Approach to Technology:** Prioritize community needs, local context, and ground realities before selecting or deploying technology solutions. Encouraging locally-driven innovations that address actual challenges and can be scaled based on proven success.
- 2. Enhance Inclusion and Capacity Building:** Ensure equitable access to digital infrastructure and services, particularly marginalized groups. Invest in training programs to build digital literacy and skills, enabling communities to actively participate in and benefit from innovation.
- 3. Foster Strong Partnerships for Impact:** Build coalitions across government, private sector, academia, and communities. Encourage cross-city and cross-country learning to spread proven solutions and accelerate adoption.
- 4. Strengthening Governance as an Anchor for Innovation:** Put clear governance frameworks in place to safeguard the public interest while enabling innovation. Establish transparency and accountability including data ethics and responsible procurement.
- 5. Ensure Sustainability and Resilience in Digital Transformation:** Embed climate resilience and sustainability in all digital initiatives. Use technology for environmental monitoring, disaster preparedness, and smart resource management.

SPECIAL SESSION 10 - REIMAGINING URBAN GOVERNANCE THROUGH INTEGRATION AND INCLUSION

SPEAKERS

Name	Position and Organisation	Role
Dr. Rita Padawangi	Associate Professor, Singapore University of Social Sciences	Moderator
Dr. Sunil Dubey	City Strategy & Ed Lead, UNSW Cities Institute, Sydney	Keynote Speaker
Madam Sanisah Binti Shafie	Director, Regional Planning Division, PLAN Malaysia	Keynote Speaker
Mr. Dang Minh Nam	Deputy Director, Hue Institute of Development Studies, Hue City, Vietnam	Panellist
Mr. Sebastian Markart	Project Director, Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit (GIZ)	Panellist
Mr. Tony Chan	Planning Leader Southeast Asia, Arup	Panellist

SESSION OBJECTIVES

- Discuss how digital transformation and innovative solutions can improve urban services, enhance inclusivity, and strengthen resilience in ASEAN cities.
- Present and exchange practical examples from city governments, private sector actors, and development partners on implementing smart city initiatives.
- Identify enabling conditions, including supportive policies, financing mechanisms, and capacity development, that allow cities to adopt and sustain digital innovations.
- Highlight challenges such as digital divide, data privacy, and interoperability, and explore strategies to address them.

SUMMARY OF PRESENTATIONS

EXPERT DIVE-IN

SPEAKER:

Dr. Sunil Dubey, City Strategy & Ed Lead, UNSW Cities Institute, Sydney

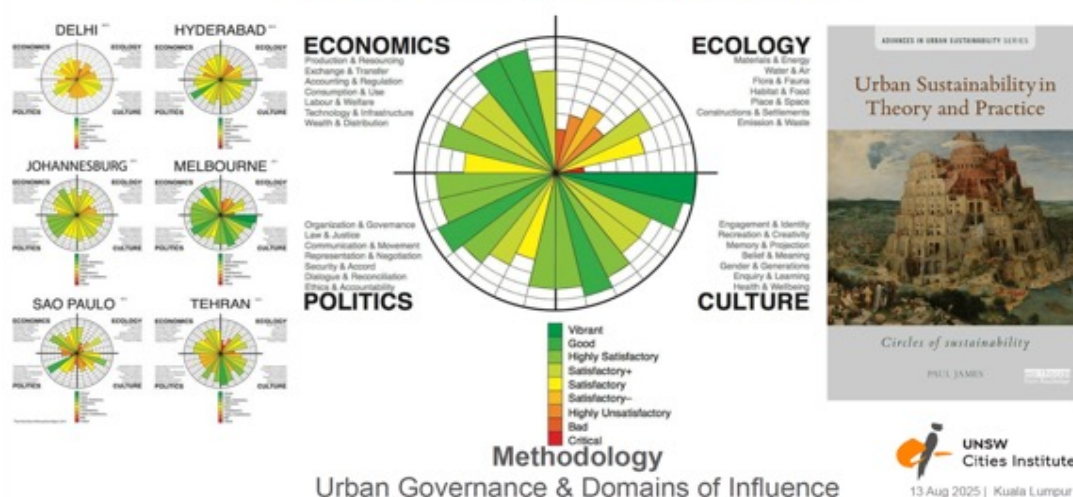
SUMMARY

Dr. Sunil Dubey presented a global perspective on urban transformation, emphasizing the unique position of ASEAN cities. He argued that these cities, shaped by a culture of "activation," require a fundamental shift from rigid, colonial-era structural planning to a more dynamic form of "city making." This new paradigm demands investment beyond physical assets into **intangible infrastructure** like digital pathways that foster innovation. He stressed that urban sustainability must be addressed holistically across four key domains: economics, politics, culture, and ecology, to create resilient and thriving urban environments.



To drive this change, Dr. Dubey highlighted the critical role of **strong city leadership**, citing transformative mayors from Seoul to Medellín as examples of how visionary leaders can tackle major challenges like digital innovation and social equity. He asserted that effective governance also depends on robust institutions and collaborative ecosystems capable of integrating technology into city services.

Governance



With rapid urbanization projected for the coming years, he warned that cities must evolve to remain equitable and sustainable, quoting Richard Nixon that "the cradle of civilization doesn't become its grave." The biggest challenge for ASEAN, he concluded, is achieving this sustainable urbanization while managing immense environmental and energy demands.

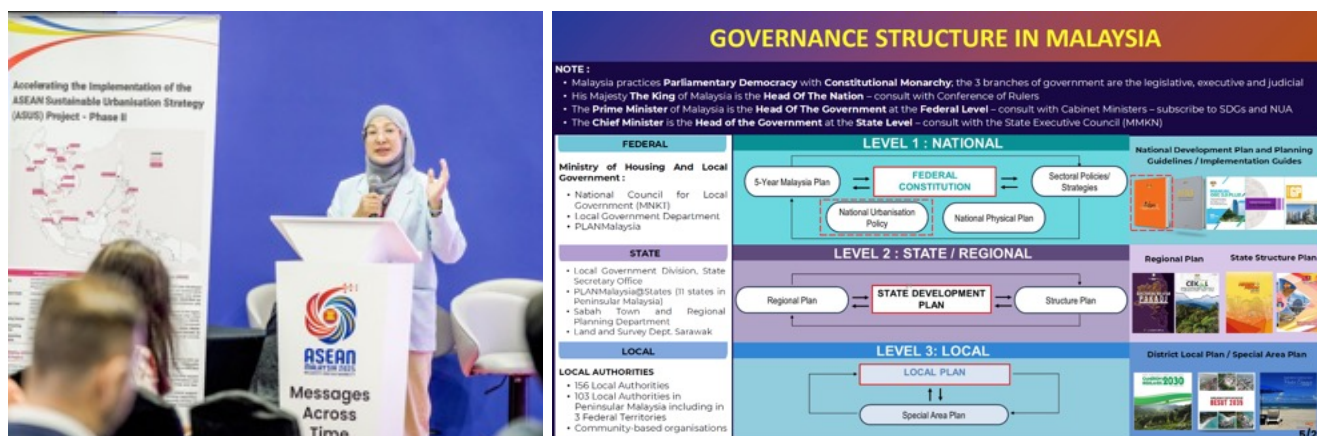
LOCALISED SOLUTION

SPEAKER:

Madam Sanisah Binti Sha ie, Director of Regional Planning Division, PLANMalaysia

SUMMARY

Madam Sanisah Binti Sha ie outlined Malaysia's structured, multi-level approach to urban governance, which is founded on the principles of accountability, transparency, empowerment, and broad stakeholder participation. She explained that the country's growth is guided by the **National Urbanisation Policy 2016–2025**, which categorizes cities into a five-tier hierarchy and is supported by key legislation like the Town and Country Planning Act. This framework has enabled several Malaysian cities to become "champions" for specific Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), such as **Shah Alam** as a low-carbon city, **Petaling Jaya** as a child-friendly city, and Seberang as a circular city.



Despite these successes, she identified pressing challenges, including rapid urbanization, climate resilience, an aging population, and urban land scarcity. To address these issues, she called for a series of strategic actions to modernize governance. These include adopting a corporate governance approach, implementing whole-of-government strategic planning to ensure coordination, and fostering collaborative urban ecosystems between public, private, and community stakeholders. Key recommendations also include enhancing local government autonomy, promoting data-driven and transparent decision-making, and expanding participatory planning to ensure that urban development is both smart and inclusive.

“In fact, no nation, I think, should face govern a disturbance century alone. So, all agencies and stakeholders must be coordinated, must share best practices, our expertise and coming to transparency, sustainability and diversity in every.”

Ms. Sanjeevani Dilanthi Singh

PANEL DISCUSSION HIGHLIGHTS

Mr. Dang Minh Nam shared Hue City's experience in balancing cultural preservation with climate adaptation as a world heritage site. He highlighted the successful 2024 relocation of 4,000 households from the old citadel, noting that the project gained strong community support because the environmental benefits and improved living conditions were clearly communicated. He emphasized that data-driven governance, advanced through a 3D GIS urban data project with Australian partners, has significantly improved planning. Moving forward, he stressed the need for continued community engagement, stronger international partnerships for technology transfer, and embedding global frameworks like the SDGs into local city planning.



Mr. Sebastian Markart focused on the importance of fostering deep collaboration for sustainable development, stressing the necessity of having experts based in the cities who speak the local language and understand local contexts. He explained that effective solutions emerge from a process of "co-understanding and co-production" with diverse city stakeholders, where feedback from the local level informs national legislation and creates a strong sense of ownership. To ensure project longevity, he advocated for anchoring initiatives in legal and policy frameworks and maintaining regular follow-up to translate consultations into tangible, lasting solutions.

Mr. Tony Chan addressed the overlapping challenges of climate change and deglobalization facing Asia-Pacific cities, introducing the 3A Governance Framework (Anticipatory, Adaptive, and Accountable) as a tool to shift from reactive to proactive planning. He highlighted that regional successes have emerged from both top-down national policies and dynamic bottom-up models, such as Iloilo City's community-led transformation. Mr. Chan emphasized the need for deep, intentional inclusivity, citing a model from Indonesia where roundtable discussions are designed to ensure all voices are heard on equal footing, concluding that meaningful adaptation requires trusted facilitators who can mobilize resources and directly engage with often-excluded local communities.



WAY FORWARD

1. Adopt process-oriented urban governance: Replace one-size-fits-all models with adaptive systems thinking. Institutionalize learning cycles (after-action reviews, iterative plans) to enable continuous adaptation and innovation.

2. Localize global challenges with Participatory Solutions: Translate international priorities into locally tailored strategies that address specific socio-cultural, institutional, and environmental contexts. Embed participatory planning to ensure outcomes are shaped by local realities and meaningfully engage all stakeholders.

3. Uphold Core Values through Institutional Safeguards: Uphold integration and inclusion as guiding principles across all governance processes with strengthened institutional mechanisms that ensure transparency, accountability, and resilience, even under diverse or challenging power structures.

“Thinking about our city as a process not a project, involving difference stakeholders to make cities actually more resilient and that is actually the reimagination.”

Dr. Rita Padawangi



SPECIAL SESSION 11 - STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIPS AND FUNDING FOR SMART AND SUSTAINABLE CITIES

SPEAKERS

Name	Position and Organisation	Role
Ms. Anita Ahmad	Chief Executive Officer, MySDG Foundation	Moderator
Ms. Wan Ling Koh	Senior Manager, Access Partnership	Keynote Speaker
Mr. Markurius Anwar	Vice-Mayor, Pekanbaru, Indonesia	Keynote Speaker
Mr. Nguyen Van Giang	Deputy Head of the Urban Development Strategy and Planning Division, Ministry of Construction in Vietnam	Panellist
Mr. Dominador Lagare	City Advisor, General Santos City	Panellist
Ms. Jazlyn Lee	Engagement Lead, Southeast Asia and South Asia, Global Covenant of Mayors	Panellist
Mr. Kelvin Vergara Tagnipez	Global Cities Engagement Lead, International Finance Corporation, APEX Green Cities	Panellist

SESSION OBJECTIVES

- Identify practical strategies to boost local governments' own-source revenue and fiscal autonomy.
- Share tools and success stories for increasing the bankability of urban projects and their readiness to receive investment.
- Showcase inclusive financial mechanisms such as community funds, pro-poor credit, and participatory budgeting that can be integrated into local governments' financial structures to prioritise vulnerable populations.

SUMMARY OF PRESENTATIONS

EXPERT DIVE-IN

SPEAKER:

Ms. Wan Ling Koh, Senior Manager, Access Partnership

SUMMARY

Ms. Wan Ling Koh emphasized that ASEAN cities face significant financing challenges for smart city projects, largely due to an over-reliance on public funding and a limited understanding of diverse financial instruments. She explained that regulatory and legal gaps further complicate matters, hindering innovative financing models and discouraging private sector participation. This knowledge gap prevents cities from identifying the right tools to unlock private investment, which is crucial for the development and scaling of ambitious smart city initiatives across the region.



To bridge this divide, she introduced the **ASEAN Smart Financing Toolkit**, a comprehensive digital resource designed to empower city officials. The toolkit features a **Library of Financing Instruments and Case Studies** to build foundational knowledge, alongside a **Financial Instrument Recommendation and Selection Tool (FIRST)** that provides tailored suggestions for specific projects. To further support users, the platform includes an **AI-powered Smart City Assistant** for customized advice and an interactive discussion board to foster knowledge sharing. With features like ASEAN language localisation and mobile compatibility, the toolkit aims to be an accessible, self-guided platform that helps cities build bankable projects and attract the private capital needed for sustainable urban transformation.

Key features of the ASEAN Smart City Financing Toolkit



**Aus4ASEAN
FUTURES**

1. Library of financing instruments and case studies

Write-ups on the benefits, challenges and enabling conditions needed to support implementation for each instrument.

Case studies to illustrate the application of specific instruments.



2. "Financial Instrument Recommendation and Selection Tool (FIRST)" filter

Filter function that allows AMS to shortlist specific instruments based on project needs.

3. Discussion board

Discussion board allows users to post discussion topics and ask and reply to questions. This facilitates engagement and knowledge sharing among platform users.

4. Smart City Assistant

This AI-enabled chatbot trained on a small-language model will provide customised responses to users inquiring about smart-city financing and any relevant instruments. The chatbot taps on information from a curated pool of websites.

Other features:

- Access to useful third-party resources
- Mobile compatibility
- Multi-lingual capabilities - localisation into ASEAN languages
- Self-help support - instructional video on how to navigate the toolkit

LOCALISED SOLUTION

SPEAKER:

Mr. Markurius Anwar, Vice-Mayor, Pekanbaru, Indonesia

SUMMARY

Mr. Markurius Anwar outlined Pekanbaru's comprehensive urban development strategy, which focuses on expanding transport infrastructure, improving public services, and boosting economic inclusion. He highlighted the city's two flagship projects: the expansion of the **70-metre Pekanbaru Ring Road** to improve logistics and open development in fringe areas, and the implementation of a **Bus Rapid Transit (BRT) system** intended to serve as the backbone of public transport. These major infrastructure investments are complemented by enhancements to non-motorised transport to ensure seamless first- and last-mile connectivity for residents.



He stressed that these ambitious projects are supported by a strong foundation of policy and dedicated funding. Key regulations now allocate a significant percentage of the municipal budget and regional taxes specifically for public transport construction and maintenance, ensuring long-term financial stability. Beyond infrastructure, Pekanbaru's strategy includes robust support for economic growth, such as a programme to empower **1,000 young entrepreneurs** and partnerships with local banks to promote cashless payments. By also investing in **EV charging infrastructure** and other sustainable mobility solutions, the city is pursuing an integrated, multi-stakeholder approach to build a resilient and economically vibrant urban future.

STRATEGIES TO ENHANCE LOCAL REVENUE



INCLUSIVE FINANCIAL MECHANISM

An inclusive financial mechanism aims to ensure that all segments of society, especially vulnerable groups, have access to financial resources. This includes **community funds, pro-poor credit schemes, and participatory budgeting** integrated into the regional financial system.



Initiative with inclusive financial mechanism in Pekanbaru:

1000 New Young Entrepreneurs

Providing targeted support in the form of training, mentorship, startup capital, and market access.

Community Empowerment Initiative of 100 Billions Fund

Community empowerment initiative allocating IDR 100 million per neighborhood unit (RW), directly promoting economic self-reliance and community-based poverty alleviation.

“We need to cover collaboration, Gov., private sector and citizen to make cities of the future connected, sustainable, resilient, inclusive and caring for.”

Mr. Markurius Anwar

PANEL DISCUSSION HIGHLIGHTS

Mr. Nguyen Van Giang explained that Vietnam's recent governance reforms have significantly empowered local administrations by granting provinces, wards, and communes greater fiscal autonomy. This decentralization gives local authorities direct control over their budgets, investment projects, and economic development initiatives. He noted that this bottom-up empowerment is aligned with the country's national sustainable urban development strategy, which integrates climate resilience and green growth, supported by tools like Public-Private Partnerships (PPPs) and dedicated innovation funds to help all cities effectively raise and manage their own finances.



Mr. Dominador Lagare provided a compelling case study from General Santos City, demonstrating how it significantly boosted its locally sourced revenue through innovative financing and strategic asset management. He described how the city secured a loan to develop a landfill, which was repaid in just two years and now generates substantial annual income from tipping fees and household charges. He also highlighted a new ordinance that empowered local barangays by incentivizing waste collection and the pivotal role of PPPs, underscoring how leveraging loans for revenue-generating projects can drive local economic independence.



“PPP have very large role to play to make sure that the city's project will be realized.”

Mr. Dominador Lagare



Ms. Jazlyn Lee emphasized that creating successful, bankable urban projects hinges on building strong, multi-level partnerships and ensuring comprehensive project preparation. She described the need for two key types of collaboration: deep partnerships between cities and local communities to ensure projects are needs-based, and effective coordination among all public and private stakeholders to align priorities. According to Mrs. Lee, this trust-building is essential for reducing investment risks, and she urged small and secondary cities to apply for technical assistance grants to conduct the necessary feasibility studies that make projects attractive to investors.

Mr. Kelvin Vergara Tagnipez provided a regional perspective, noting that few ASEAN countries have strong subnational governments capable of leveraging advanced municipal finance tools. He argued that for cities to meet their development and climate goals, they must diversify their financing beyond government revenues by tapping into private capital. This requires cities to strengthen their creditworthiness and establish clear PPP frameworks to attract investor confidence. Citing examples from the Philippines, Indonesia, and Vietnam, he called for wider adoption of tools like municipal bonds and encouraged participation in capacity-building programs to help cities prepare bankable projects.



WAY FORWARD

- 1. Strengthen Regulatory Frameworks for Sustainable Finance:** strengthen multi-level regulatory environments to enable the financing and implementation of initiatives. Align national laws and municipal rules; update PPP/ procurement guidelines; and issue standardized templates to speed implementation.
- 2. Invest in Sustained Capacity Building:** Cities need ongoing institutional and skills development to access and use high-quality support. Establish continuous training programs and a TA clearinghouse that leverages bilateral, multilateral, and specialized networks.
- 3. Foster Accountable Strategic Partnerships:** Impact requires coalitions across public, private, and community sectors through shared objectives, clearly defined roles, and mutual accountability. Create multi-level partnership platforms and promote mutual accountability within partnerships.



TRAINING SESSION - STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIPS AND FUNDING FOR SMART AND SUSTAINABLE CITIES

SPEAKERS

Name	Position and Organisation	Role
Ms. Wan Ling Koh	Senior Manager, Access Partnership	Keynote Speaker
Mr. Sovanarith Sieng	Urban Development Expert, UN-Habitat Bangkok Programme Office	Keynote Speaker
Ms. Bounthida Ounavong	Project Officer Lao PDR, UN-Habitat Bangkok Programme Office	Facilitator
Dr. Alyosha Ezra Mallari	Project Officer Philippines, UN-Habitat Bangkok Programme Office	Facilitator
Ms. Mula Nursetianti	Project Officer Indonesia, UN-Habitat Bangkok Programme Office	Facilitator
Ms. Neoh Siew Yin	Project Officer Malaysia, UN-Habitat Bangkok Programme Office	Facilitator

SESSION OBJECTIVES

- Provide an overview of the ASUS priority sub-areas and actions, the ASUS toolkits and the ASEAN Smart City Financing Toolkit.
- Ensure all participants can share a common language and understanding of the ASUS framework, tools, steps, and how proposals can be taken forward using the ASEAN Smart City Financing Toolkit.
- Engage ASEAN cities in a guided interactive activity on ‘Applying the ASUS toolkits’ to exchange views on case studies.

SUMMARY OF PRESENTATIONS

PRESENTATIONS

SPEAKER:

Ms. Wan Ling Koh, Senior Manager, Access Partnership and **Mr. Sovanarith Sieng**, Urban Development Expert, UN-Habitat Bangkok Programme Office

SUMMARY

The speakers introduced participants to the ASEAN Sustainable Urbanisation Strategy (ASUS) Toolkits 1 and 2, which serve as key resources to guide cities in the ASUS Phase II process—from assessing urban challenges to identifying priority areas and shaping actionable responses.

Mr. Sovanarith Sieng introduced the ASUS Toolkit 1 by explaining how to conduct a city self- assessment and prioritize an ASUS sub-areas based on defined parameters. He explained how to translate those priorities into actionable responses using structured templates updated from the Phase I. He highlighted that structure/ content of each plan/project proposal include background and rationale; objectives and key outputs; key activities; monitoring and review mechanism; management of risks and lessons learnt.

Ms. Wan Ling Koh expanded on the ASEAN Smart City Financing Toolkit and explained participants how to navigate the appropriate financing tools and instruments for smart city initiatives. During the presentation, she provided a walkthrough of the Toolkit using a real case study, and guided participants through the structure and tools available online, illustrating how to navigate the toolkit and apply its recommendations to their projects. She pointed out how cities can leverage the toolkit to identify suitable financing options and align them with project maturity and stakeholder conditions.



INTERACTIVE ACTIVITY

Through a Guided interactive activity, moderated by UN-Habitat Bangkok Programme Office staff, representatives from ASEAN cities were encouraged to cross learning and peer exchange among cities facing similar priorities. ASEAN cities were assigned to different thematic tables following as following:

- **Table 1: Safe and Secure Neighbourhoods:** 8 participants from Chiang Mai, Shah Alam, Caloocan.
- **Table 2: Water, Waste and Sanitation:** 12 participants from Nakhon Si Thammarat, Luang Prabang, Tomohon.
- **Table 3: Urban Resilience:** 10 participants from Miri, Makassar, Hatyai.
- **Table 4: Urban Mobility:** 10 participants from Kaysone, Pekanbaru, Cebu and Dili.



Participants from cities across ASEAN and the Pacific came together with different starting points but with overlapping concerns: road and pedestrian safety (e.g. Bangkok, Shah Alam), mounting organic waste and weak collection systems (e.g. Tomohon, Mandalay), exposure to floods and landslides (e.g. Miri, Auckland), and inadequate or poorly connected public transport (e.g. Bangkok, Puerto Princesa, Hadad). Many shared that they are still at an early stage, testing pilot initiatives, facing limited budgets, or depending heavily on national governments for approval or funds.

The interactive “city snapshot” exchanges allowed each city to briefly share what they are currently trying, what is proving to be difficult, and one area where they need support. The emphasis was on exchanging practical experiences, such as Rayong’s small-scale IoT health monitoring for elderly care, Chiang Mai’s experiments with smart street-lighting and disaster-relocation mapping, Tomohon’s waste-to-fertiliser efforts, or Miri’s early warning and land acquisition plans. Discussions focused less on new big projects and more on how to strengthen what is already happening, and how to make limited resources go further. The second round introduced the ASEAN Smart City Financing Toolkit, giving participants a first look at financing concepts and prompting questions about which parts of their ongoing work could eventually be shaped into proposals, but without immediate commitments.

Rather than producing fully fledged project pipelines, the session helped cities clarify and reframe their next practical steps. Participants identified peers facing similar constraints whom they could learn from after the forum, and left with ideas to adjust or scale existing measures – for instance, testing the Fukuoka landfill method in a single pilot site, or refining road-safety campaigns to strengthen law enforcement. The exposure to the financing toolkit mainly served as an initial orientation, helping cities understand the types of information and preparatory work needed if they later seek external funding. In short, the exercise built connections and surfaced realistic, incremental follow-ups, positioning cities to continue small but concrete progress rather than immediate large-scale investment projects.



CONCLUSION



The ASEAN Sustainable Urbanisation Forum (ASUF) 2025 concluded with a strong reaffirmation of the region's shared commitment to building inclusive and resilient cities. By convening city leaders, policymakers, development partners, academia, civil society, and private sector representatives, the Forum once again demonstrated its value as a regional platform for translating policy frameworks into practical, scalable action.

Over the course of the event, participants engaged in meaningful dialogue on the enablers and thematic areas of the ASEAN Sustainable Urbanisation Strategy (ASUS). Discussions highlighted both progress achieved and persistent challenges, ranging from urban resilience and climate adaptation to water, waste, and sanitation, mobility, and social inclusion. Central to these exchanges was the recognition that sustainable urbanisation requires an integrated and people-centred approach, where policies are inclusive, financing mechanisms are innovative, and governance structures foster collaboration across multiple levels.

A key outcome of ASUF 2025 was the recognition that sustainable urbanisation in ASEAN cannot be achieved in isolation. Cities must continue to build coalitions that span sectors, disciplines, and geographies. Forging stronger partnerships between local governments, national agencies, international organisations, civil society and the private sector is critical to unlocking resources, driving innovation, and scaling solutions. Equally important is the role of digital technologies and regional cooperation in improving data availability, enhancing connectivity, and enabling replication of best practices. The ASEAN Smart Cities Network was recognised for its key role in supporting exchange and learning for the implementation of viable urban solutions.

The Forum concluded with a call to action for all stakeholders to deepen collaboration and efforts to:

- Integrate ASUS priorities into local and national urban development plans.
- Enhance the coordination and exchange through initiatives such as the ASCN.
- Strengthen resilience to climate change and disasters.
- Expand access to essential services such as water, waste, and sanitation.
- Ensure inclusivity, gender equality, and social equity across urban policies and programmes.
- Mobilise financial resources and partnerships to implement scalable, impactful projects.

By bringing together diverse voices and fostering practical collaboration, the Forum laid a stronger foundation for aligning regional priorities with global goals. The event provided a clear path forward: to accelerate progress, strengthen resilience, and ensure that ASEAN's cities are equipped to provide sustainable and inclusive urban futures for all.



ANNEXES

ANNEX 1: PRESENTATIONS

The full presentations shared during ASUF 2025 can be accessed at this link: https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1jYQ0-jplaHeKGPYD_oGb98ZxW9Gbpw63?usp=share_link

ANNEX 2: EVENT PHOTO

The photographs of the whole event can be retrieved at this link: <https://unhabitat.canto.global/v/HA2RCS7C5C/folder/J8U0B?viewIndex=0>

ANNEX 3: CONCEPT NOTES AND AGENDAS

The concept notes and agendas of all sessions of ASUF 2025 can be accessed at this link: The full presentations shared during ASUF 2025 can be accessed at this link: https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1jYQ0-jplaHeKGPYD_oGb98ZxW9Gbpw63?usp=share_link

ANNEX 4: OVERALL EVENT AGENDA

In the next pages is the overall event agenda of ASEAN Sustainable Urbanisation Forum 2025, ASEAN Governors & Mayors Forum and the Meeting of Governors & Mayors of ASEAN Capitals. The sessions delivered by UN-Habitat as part of the ASEAN Sustainable Urbanisation Forum 2025 are marked.

ASEAN 2025 URBAN EXPO (HALL 1-HALL 5)

MAIN STAGE HALL 5	KL CITY STAGE HALL 4	ASEAN ARENA HALL 5	LOUNGE 4 HALL 4	LOUNGE 5 HALL 5	SDG IN ACTION HALL 4
Opening Day 3 by Convener	CITY TALK 2	SPECIAL SESSION 11	RT SESSION 3	Pairing and Learning on Waste Management UCLE ASPAC United Graduate School of Leadership Studies KUALA LUMPUR	From Connectivity to Prosperity: Unlocking Rural Opportunities Through E-Commerce Entrepreneurship, and the Digital Economy
HIGH LEVEL 5	Warisan Kuala Lumpur: Sustaining Kuala Lumpur's Identity Amid Urban Transformation	Strategic Partnerships and Funding for Smart and Sustainable Cities	The ASEAN Community Vision 2045 – Bringing Opportunities Closer to ASEAN Cities		Reviving Hope: Orangutan Conservation for Sustainable Futures in Peninsular Malaysia
Financing Models for Sustainable and Resilient Urban Development	CITY TALK 3	SPECIAL SESSION 12	UNICEF Children Friendly City Talk + MOU Signing		Women Empowerment in Tawau
SPECIAL ADDRESS : YB DATUK AMAR DE SIM Healthy & Sustainable Cities	Towards Zero Waste Cities: Challenging the impossible	Cooling and Powering Cities: Inclusive Energy For All			7 Pearl Sanctuary
HIGH LEVEL 6	CITY ACTIVITY 3	SPECIAL SESSION 13	SIDE EVENT 14		Zero-Waste To Landfill Events In Action
Vision For Future Cities and Regions: Opportunities to Transform	Kuala Lumpur in Command: Advancing Urban Intelligence Through KLCCC	Advancing NDCs Implementation through the Lens of Clean Air across ASEAN	Towards Climate- Resilient Malaysian Cities: Implementing Green City Action Plans (ICLEI – Local Governments for Sustainability)		TEX Urban Regeneration & Sustainability Sdn Bhd
	POCKET TALK		TRAINING SESSION 17	Safe School Program in Kuala Lumpur and how it scaled up	
	Bridging Delivery Gap in Smart Cities : Why Program Management & Talent Matters?		From Strategy to Impact: Implementing ASEAN Urban & Financing Toolkits (UN Habitat)		
BREAK		BREAK			
CLOSING CEREMONY	POCKET TALK				
	KL Green Connectors Sharing Session				
ASEAN 2025 URBAN EXPO (HALL 1-HALL 5)					
ASEAN Connectivity by Orchestra Kuala Lumpur – Auditorium DBKL					

ANNEX 5: PARTICIPANT LIST

Cambodia	ASCN Representative	Ministry of Interior	Mr. Sor Vorin	Under Secretary of State Ministry of Interior	Speaker
			Mr. Po Chanmuny	Deputy Director	Speaker
	ASCN Cities	Battambang	Bunrith Soeum	Deputy Governor	Attendee
			Lim Ymeng	Director One Window Service, Smart City Committee	Speaker
		Siem Reap	CHHOEUT CHAM-NAN	Officer	Attendee
		Sihanoukville	Sar Kackada	Mayor	Attendee
			Nay Sally	Deputy Director Provincial Administration	Attendee
			EM PHEAP	Deputy Governor	Attendee
		Phnom Penh	Kimchhuon MAN	Deputy head of public relations and International Cooperation Division	Attendee
	ASUS Cities	Kep City	Vuthy Khorn	Governor	Attendee
			Yaung Bun	Deputy Governor	Attendee
Indonesia	LIB-SI Representative	Ministry of National Development Planning / BAPPENAS	Dail Umamil Asri	Director of Connectivity and Logistic Infrastructure	Attendee
	ASCN Cities	Banyuwangi	Budi Santoso	Head of Department of Communications and Information	Attendee
		Makassar	Aliyah Mustika Ilham	Vice Mayor of Makassar	Speaker
			Zulfitra Dianta Anis	Head of Cooperation Office	Attendee
			Ismawaty NUR	Secretary of Department of Communication and Information	Attendee
		Sumedang	Tuti Ruswati	Secretary of Sumedang Regency	Attendee
			DONY AHMAD MUNIR	Regent	Attendee
		Pekanbaru	Sunarko	Head, Department of Transport, City of Pekanbaru	Attendee
			Markurius Anwar	Vice Mayor of Pekanbaru	Speaker
		Tomohon	Caroll Joram Azarias Senduk	Mayor of Tomohon	Attendee
			Ferdinand Mono Turang	Chairman of Tomohon City House of Representatives / DPRD Tomohon	Attendee

Lao PDR	ASCN Representative	Ministry of Public Works and Transport (Department of Housing and Urban Planning)	Souksavanh HA-NEPHOM	Smart City Expert	Attendee
		Ministry of Public Works and Transport (Department of Planning and Cooperation)	Dr. Bounta ON-NAVONG	Director General	Attendee
	LIB-SI Representative	Ministry of Public Works and Transport (Department of Planning and Cooperation)	Souricharth Siri-phongh	Technical Staff	Attendee
	ASCN Cities	Luang Prabang	Vilayphone Than-omsack	Vice Mayor	Attendee
			YENGHER VACHA	Deputy Head Office	Speaker
		Vientiane	SOMCHAIVANG DETHOUDOM	Deputy Director General	Attendee
	ASUS Cities	Oudomxay	Mr Anousack Vong-phachanh	Technical Officer of Housesing and Urban Planning	Attendee
			Somnuek Sitthilath	Deputy District Governor	Attendee
		Kaysone / Savannakhet	Vannaleth Phaop-hongsavath	Kaysone Phomvihane City Administration Office	Attendee
			Khamphoui Siboun-heuang	Acting Mayor of Kaysone Phomvihane City	Attendee
Malaysia	ASCN Representative	Ministry of Housing and Local Government Malaysia	Mohd Hazli b Ahmad	Deputy Secretary General	Speaker
			Datuk Wira M Noor Azman Bin Taib	Secretary General	Speaker
	ASCN Cities	Ipoh	ABDUL AFIQ BIN MUHAMMAD	Chief Smart City Officer (Ipoh) / Town Planner	Attendee
		Johor Bahru/Iskandar Puteri	Ahmad Nazir bin Hj Mohd Nasir	Mayor	Attendee
			Shamsudin Yusoff	Senior Vice President, IRDA	Attendee
			SHAHROLIZAM BIN ABDUL RASHID	Deputy Secretary	Attendee
		Kuching	Rudazaimeir Malek	Deputy Director	Speaker
			Mr Hemlet Anak Kiai	Head, Digital Technology Division, Sarawak Multimedia Authority (SMA)	Attendee
	ASUS Cities	Shah Alam	Dato' Haji Mohd Fauzi bin Haji Mohd Yatim	Mayor	Attendee
			TPr. Aniza binti Haji Osman	Deputy Secretary	Speaker
		Miri	ADAM YII SIEW SANG	YB Mayor	Attendee
			Abdul Rahman bin Taupek	Ag. City Secretary	Attendee

Myanmar	ASCN/ASUS Cities	Yangon	KHIN SU SU WINT	Government Staff Officer	Attendee
		Yangon	TIN TIN KYI	Deputy Director General	Attendee
Philippines	ASCN Representative	Department of the Interior and Local Government	Lilian M. De Leon	Assistant to the Secretary	Speaker
	ASCN Cities	Cebu City	Ann Marie Y. Cuizon	CPDO Asst. Dept. Head	Attendee
			GERALDINE EWICAN DE LA CERNA	Project Development Officer	Attendee
		Davao City	Tristan Dwight Domingo	Assistant City Administrator / Chief Smart City Officer	Attendee
	ASUS Cities	Caloocan	Josephine dela Cruz	Officer in Charge	Attendee
			Ma. Relizah Cruz	Project Evaluation Officer	Attendee
		General Santos	DOMINADOR S. LAGARE JR	City Councilor	Speaker
			Reinhard Lee P. Amoro	Engr.	Attendee
Timor Leste		Ministry of Rural Development and Community Housing	Jacinta dos Santos	Head of Research Ethics Department	Attendee
			Gaudencia Cecilia da Cruz Costa	n/a	Attendee
Thailand	ASCN Representative	Ministry of Digital Economy and Society (Digital Economy Promotion Agency)	Non Arkaraprasertkul	Senior Expert in Smart City Promotion	Speaker
		Chiang Mai	Pradya Koamnee	Chiang Mai CSCO secretary / Manager of Northern Region)	Speaker
			Pongsak Kaewsuenmuang	Director of Strategy and Information for Provincial Development Unit	Attendee
		Phuket	Bussayamas Pimaporn	Digital Promotion Officer (Smart City)	Attendee
			Ton Jaitrong	Team Leader	Attendee
		Rayong	Abhichartbut Rodyong	Vice President	Attendee
	ASUS Cities	Hat Yai	Jitsadanooch Saengsri	Public Relation	Attendee
		Nakhon Si Thammarat	Chatchai Arunsuwankorn	Deputy Mayor	Attendee
			Yongyuth Gaewkumpai	Civil Engineer, Professional Level	Attendee

Viet Nam	ASCN Representative	Ministry of Construction	Nguyen Van Giang	Deputy Head of Strategy and Planning Department	Speaker
	ASUS Cities	Hue	Huynh Minh Khang	Deputy Director	Attendee
			Dang Minh Nam	Vice Director	Attendee
		Bac Giang	Nguyen Duy Hung	Deputy Chief of Office	Attendee
			Trieu Tien Dat	Deputy Head of Economic, Infrastructure and Urban Affairs Department	Attendee
		Sa Pa	Pham Tien Dung	Vice Chairman of Ward	Attendee
			Pham Tuan Anh	Deputy Head of Economic, Infrastructure and Urban Affairs Department	Attendee

Experts	ITDP Indonesia	Gonggomtua Sitanggang	Director	Attendee
	World Bank	Christian Kelvin Vergara Tagnipez	Operations Officer	Speaker
	Asian Disaster Preparedness Center	Peeranan Towashiraporn	Director, Risk Analytics and Climate Services	Speaker
	Access Partnership	Abhineet Manohar Kaul	Director	Speaker
	Access Partnership	Wan Ling Koh	Senior Manager	Speaker
	EY Corporate Advisors Pte Ltd	Bingxun Seng	Partner Economic Advisory Leader	Speaker
	UNSW Cities Institute Sydney	Sunil Dubey	Associate Professor	Speaker
	Institute of Smart City and Management (ISCM), University of Economics Ho Chi Minh City	TRINH TU ANH	Associate Professor	Speaker
	ARUP	Yong Wei CHAN (Tony)	Cities Planning and Design Leader, South-east Asia	Speaker
	GIZ	Sebastian Frederic Markart	Project Head Urban Act India	Speaker
	Singapore University of Social Sciences	Rita Padawangi	Associate Professor	Speaker
	Safetipin	Kalpana Viswanath Basu	Co Founder and CEO	Speaker
	ESE Co. Ltd	Changho Lee	Executive Vice President	Speaker
	C40 Cities	Alissa Raj	Deputy Regional Director for East, Southeast Asia, and Oceania	Speaker
	Plan Malaysia	Sanisah binti Shafie	Director of Regional Planning Division	Speaker
	Thua Thien Hue Institute for Development Studies	Dang Minh Nam	Vice Director	Speaker
	Think City Malaysia	Yogi Chellappan	Senior Manager & Interim Lead - Climate Resilience	Speaker
	YayasanMySDG	Anita Ahmad	Chief Executive Officer	Speaker
	Nippon Koei Co.,Ltd.	Akihito Muto	Chief Section, Smart City and Urban Development Department	Speaker
	Telekom Malaysia	Hairol Samad	General Manager - Smart Solution Division	Speaker
	The Huairou Commission	Sri Husnaini Sofjan	Senior Program Administrator & Strategist	Speaker

Expert	Singapore - ETH Centre	Evi Syariffudin	Module Coordinator, Future Cities Lab	Speaker
	C40 Cities	Jazlyn Lee	Regional Lead	Speaker
	ESCAP	Sanjeevani Dilanthi Singh	Economic Affairs Officer	Speaker
	DEPA	Supakorn Siddhichai	Executive Vice President	Speaker
	Ministry of Trade and Industry & Ministry of Culture, Community and Youth	Low Yen Ling	Senior Minister of State	Speaker
	Centre for Indonesia-Malaysia-Thailand Growth Triangle Subregional Cooperation (CIMT)	Duangruetai Surasakjinda	Deputy Director	Speaker
ASEAN Secretariat ACD	ASEAN Connectivity Division	Lim Chze Cheen	Director	Speaker
	ASEAN Connectivity Division	Benazir Syahril	Senior Officer	Attendee
	ASEAN Connectivity Division	Betsy Caroline Lengkong	Officer	Attendee
Australia	Australia Mission to ASEAN	Lara Franzen	Counsellor	Speaker
	Aus4ASEAN	Royce Elving Escolar	Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning Adviser	Attendee
	Aus4ASEAN	Muhammad Scessardi Kemalsyah	Programme Officer	Attendee
UN Habitat Team	UN-HABITAT	Kazuko Ishigaki	Regional Director ROAP	Speaker
	UN-HABITAT	Srinivasa Popuri	Chief, ROAP Bangkok Multicountry Office	Speaker
	UN-HABITAT	Angela Mwai	Chief of the Human Rights and Social Inclusion	Speaker
	UN-HABITAT	Natsuho Ihoroi	Assistant Development Coordination Officer	Speaker
	UN-HABITAT	Elena Boni	Urban Development Expert, KM Coordinator	Organiser
	UN-HABITAT	Carmen Fleitas	Communications Expert	Organiser
	UN-HABITAT	Sovanarith Sieng	Urban Development Expert	Organiser
	UN-HABITAT	Ei-Lyn Chia	Urban Research Associate	Organiser
	UN-HABITAT	Patthiya Gitpot	Local Project Officer	Organiser
	UN-HABITAT	Sensamras Piseth	Local Project Officer	Organiser
	UN-HABITAT	Alyosha Ezra Mallari	Local Project Officer	Organiser
	UN-HABITAT	Bounthida Ounavong	Local Project Officer	Organiser
	UN-HABITAT	Cuong Kieu	Acting Manager of the Country Officer	Organiser
	UN-HABITAT	Mula Pralampita Nursetianti	Local Project Officer	Organiser
	UN-HABITAT	Neoh Siew Yin	Local Project Officer	Organiser
	UN-HABITAT	Khairulnisa Bahrum	Project Assistant	Organiser
	UN-HABITAT	Kyu Thin Cho	Local Project Officer	Organiser



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